

ACHIEVE!



History

ROME 1

THE ANCIENT WORLD

Chrissie Michaels



Made for the
Australian Curriculum



Achieve! History

Get ready for the Australian Curriculum with editable worksheets that have been written for the needs of low literacy students.

Features

- ✓ Worksheets that help low literacy students understand key content and concepts.
- ✓ Activities designed to reinforce and enhance literacy skills.
- ✓ Emphasis on essential historical knowledge, understanding and skills.
- ✓ Comprehensive Teacher's Notes that provide clear objectives, background information, starter and extension activities.
- ✓ CD-ROM containing all pages from the book making them ideal for use on Interactive Whiteboards.
- ✓ Editable Word files on the CD-ROM that can be edited to suit the specific needs of students.
- ✓ All illustrations are included on the CD-ROM and can be used on new teacher created worksheets.



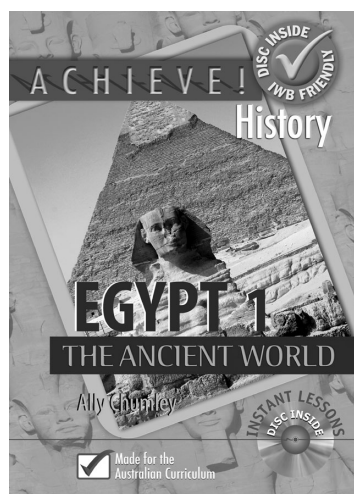
Software requirements

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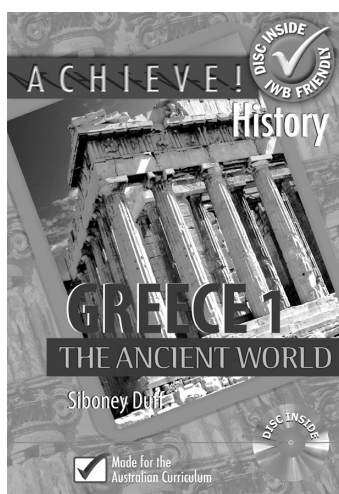
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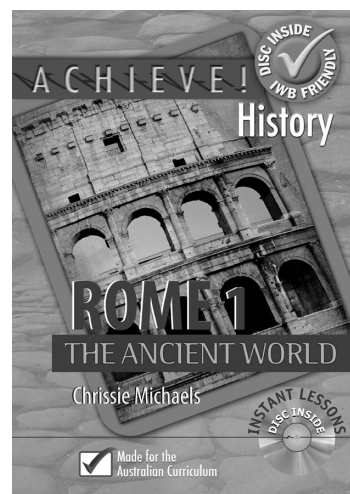
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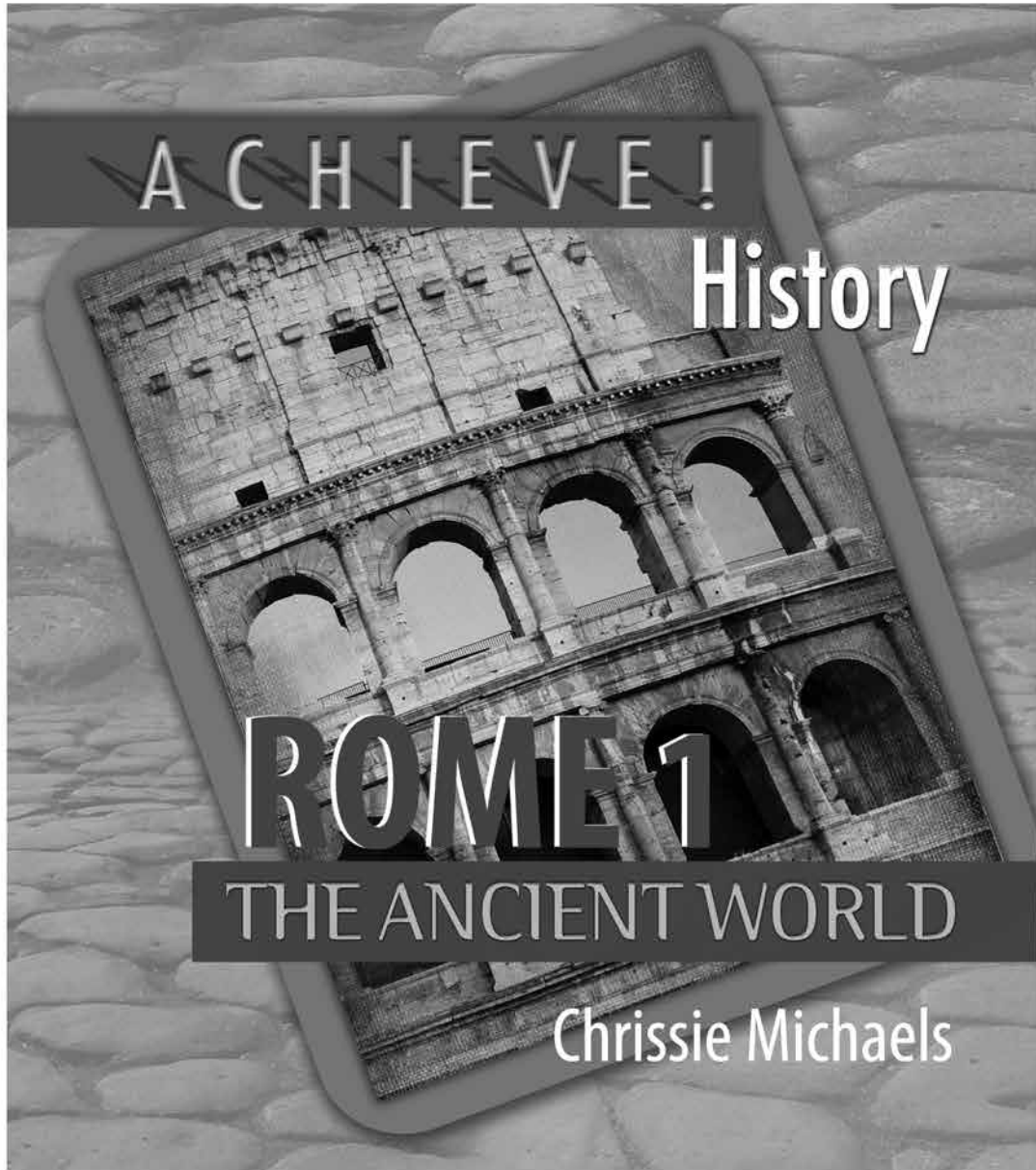
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Introduction	4	
1 The foundations of Rome ACDSEH004 ACHHS210	5	6 Gladiators ACDSEH038
Origins of Rome (1)	6	Gladiator combat
Origins of Rome (2)	7	Gladiator FAQ
Using material evidence	8	Wild animals in the arena
The legend of Romulus and Remus	9	Secutor's fan club
		Changing attitudes
2 Roman society ACDSEH038	10	7 Pompeii ACHHS209 ACHHS210
The Senate	11	Pompeii is buried
A career in the Senate	12	Mount Vesuvius erupts
Patricians	13	A personal view of Pompeii
Relationships in Roman society	14	Pompeii casts
Plebeians	15	Daily life in Pompeii
Plebeians and patricians	16	Cause and effect
3 Julius Caesar ACDSEH131 ACHHS210	17	8 Roman houses ACDSEH039
A powerful general and leader	18	Living in Rome
Caesar's murder	19	Living in the country
Caesar and Brutus	20	Roman houses (1)
Vox pop (1)	21	Roman houses (2)
Vox pop (2)	22	
4 The Roman Legion ACDSEH039 ACHHS206	23	9 Religion ACDSEH038 ACDSEH039
A Roman legion	24	Family tree of early Roman gods
Uniform, weapons and training	25	The Dii Consentes
An organised fighting unit	26	A god for every purpose
Join a Roman legion!	27	Calendar of religious festivals
Major wars and conquests	28	Religious festivals, beliefs and daily life
5 Slave or free ACDSEH038	29	10 The great road builders ACDSEH040
Free-born citizens	30	The Appian Way opens
Slaves	31	Master road builders
Slave or free?	32	All roads lead to Rome
A slave's work	33	Remarkable Roman road facts
Free at last	34	Great builders

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The *Achieve!* series of History titles has been developed for teachers who require modified, curriculum-focused activities for secondary school students who struggle to read and comprehend regular classroom materials because of poor literacy skills. Many of the pages will also be suitable as supplementary material for regular classes.

The Ancient World: Rome 1 enables students to develop their historical knowledge and understanding of Ancient Rome through the study of the land's physical features, everyday Roman life and society, patricians and plebeians, the importance of religion, gladiators and Pompeii, the influence of war and Julius Caesar. The content addresses key historical skills and concepts, including understanding sources and evidence, reasons for change and continuity, locating and categorising information and different perspectives.

The CD contains all the pages that are featured in the book, as well as a file of illustrations that can be used for other worksheets. These documents can be easily edited to suit the individual needs of students.

This book is divided into ten units, each of which contains one or more photocopiable resource sheets and several activity worksheets. This will allow teachers to use the material in a variety of ways. For example, the unit could be taught as a lesson with students in groups of varying sizes. Alternatively, a single resource sheet and related activity sheets can be used as support material, for individual homework, assessment or revision.

The teacher's notes provide valuable guidance about using each unit, and contain the following elements.

Objectives – These are the key skills and knowledge learnt through using the worksheets.

Prior knowledge – This refers to the skills and knowledge required for students to complete the tasks. Some activities are more challenging than others, however, as a rule, students should have a reading comprehension age of six to nine years to be able to attempt the activities.

Background – This section provides additional guidance to help teachers to present a successful lesson. It may include definitions or further background notes about the subject matter.

Starter activity – Warm-up activities are provided to put the content into proper context and to gain student interest and attention.

Resource and activity worksheets – The resource sheets do not always contain activities and are used either to stimulate discussion or as a part of the unit's activities. The activity worksheets may be used sequentially or as stand-alone tasks, depending on the needs of the student.

Extension activities – Additional tasks are suggested to recap on the main skills or knowledge taught in the lesson, as well as ways to extend, assess or include technology in the lesson.

Curriculum links – The Australian Curriculum: Year 7 – The Ancient World: The Mediterranean

Objectives

- To sequence how Rome was formed and describe how physical features such as the Seven Hills and the River Tiber influenced the early settlement of Rome
- To identify and describe examples of written and material evidence used by modern historians to build a picture of Rome's formation
- To use an example from traditional storytelling about the foundation of Rome and to draw a conclusion about an early Roman religious belief

Prior knowledge

Students should be able to find Italy on a map. They should understand the terms *archaeologist* and *historian*.

Background

Both the writing of historians from the ancient world and material evidence (structures and artefacts) shape our understanding of the formation of Rome. These also give us insight into the beliefs and practices of Ancient Romans.

The natural features of the area around Rome shaped its development. The Palatine Hill's proximity to the lowest crossing point of the River Tiber was what most likely led to it eventually being selected as the site of the main city of Rome.

Starter activity

Begin by discussing with students what a legend is. Ask students to share some family stories and discuss how these may have changed over time. Brainstorm reasons why this may happen. Discuss what turns a story into a legend.

Resource and Activity sheets

The Activity sheets 'Origins of Rome (1)' and 'Origins of Rome (2)' provide information about where and how Rome started, based on natural features and material evidence. Students should complete these sheets and then complete the Activity sheet 'Using material evidence'.

Read the Activity sheet 'The legend of Romulus and Remus' with the class, and then ask them to discuss how the legend makes Rome sound powerful and important. What evidence has been found that links to a legend about how Rome was founded? How much fact is found in legends?

Extension activity

Students could research the origins of their own city or town, and then write their own legend or myth about how it began.

Answers

Using material evidence Artefacts: flint axes, funeral urns; **Remains:** Neanderthal skulls; **Structures:** Etruscan tomb; **Natural features/landscape:** Seven Hills, marshlands, River Tiber; **Order:** Groups live apart ... Tribes drain ... Rome becomes a city...

The legend of Romulus and Remus **1** Palatine Hill; **2** Aventine Hill; **3** Rome became a city in 753 BCE; the Sabines were the first people to live in Rome; **4** Legends are fiction, but some may also include some facts.



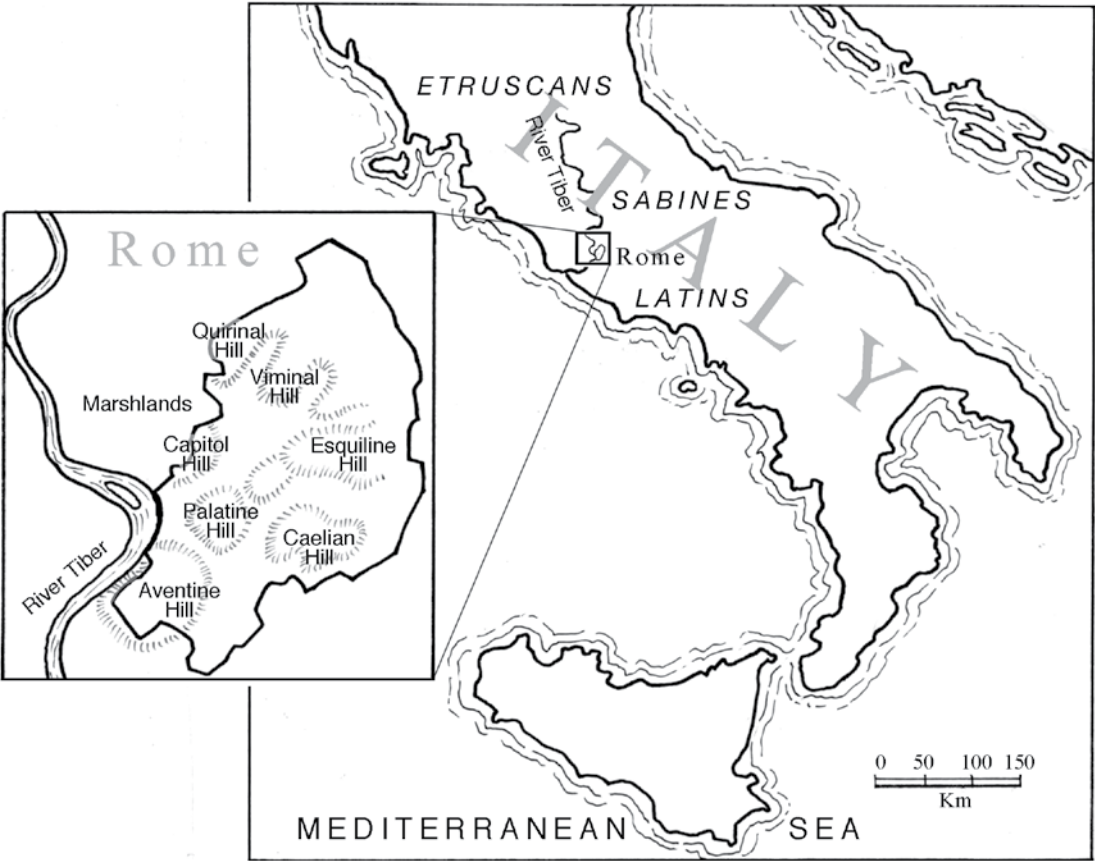
Origins of Rome (1)

Material evidence suggests that people settled in Italy as early as 200 000 years ago. Archaeologists have found flint axes and, near Rome, Neanderthal skulls. This evidence suggests to historians that the early inhabitants lived short, nomadic lives.



Neanderthal skull

The Etruscans, Sabines and Latins were groups of people who settled in the area near where Rome would begin. The main hills near the River Tiber are known as the **Seven Hills**. Modern historians believe that tribes settled down in the area some time before 1200 BCE. These groups of people built huts on the Seven Hills, where it was easier to defend themselves.



- Consider the map above then answer the following questions in your workbook.
- 1 Why you think so many tribes chose to settle in the Seven Hills area?
 - 2 What advantage did the hills and river provide?

Origins of Rome (2)

Over time the villages on the **Seven Hills** grew. The people drained the marshlands that had kept them apart and set up markets. The River Tiber became a busy route for trade. Because the Palatine Hill was near the lowest crossing point of the river it had the strongest position, and the village located there became the main city of Rome. Modern historians believe that Rome became a city around 753 BCE.

Material evidence

Material evidence is any object that helps us to understand the past. The discovery of small funeral urns on the Palatine Hill suggests that the people who lived there burned their dead. Archaeologists know that the Latins and Sabines used this practice. In contrast, the Etruscans buried their dead in huge tombs shaped like houses. The presence of funeral urns on Palatine Hill has led some historians to believe that the Latins and Sabines were Rome's first townspeople.



Funeral urn



Etruscan tomb

-  1 Underline in blue the sentence that tells why the Palatine Hill was chosen as the main site for Rome.
- 2 Underline in red the sentence that tells us who some historians believe were most likely Rome's first townspeople.

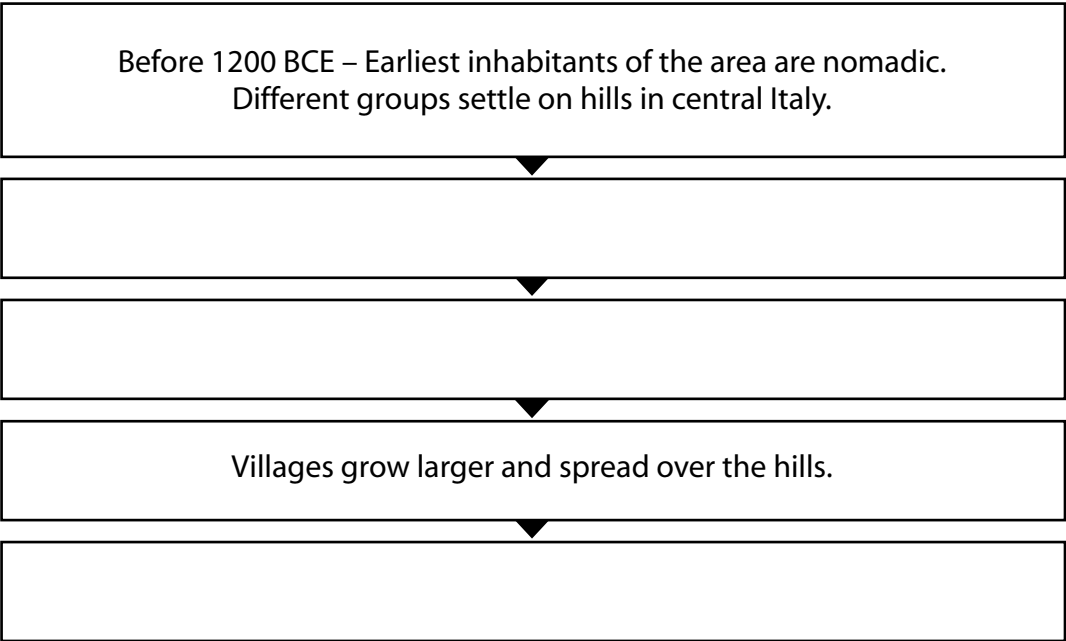
Using material evidence

 1 In the boxes below, write examples of the **material evidence** used by historians to find out about the early settlement of Rome.

Artefacts 	Remains (human or animal) 
Built structures 	Natural features/landscape

2 Complete the timeline to show how the city of Rome developed. Select the missing events from the box.

Tribes drain the marshlands and trade with one another.
Rome becomes a city around 753 BCE.
Groups live apart from one another.



The legend of Romulus and Remus

A **legend** is a story passed down from earlier times, which often mixes fact with fiction. The Roman historian Livy made the beginning of Rome sound exciting, romantic and powerful in the following story, which became a legend.

Romulus and Remus

Twin boys called **Romulus** and **Remus** were born to Mars, the Roman god of war, and the daughter of a king. The twins' wicked uncle wanted no threats to the throne, so he left the twins by the River Tiber to die. A she-wolf found the boys and cared for them, until a shepherd rescued and raised them. When they grew up, the brothers discovered who they really were.

As princes, they had many followers and they each chose to live on different hills – Romulus on the **Palatine Hill**, Remus on the **Aventine Hill**. Each brother wanted to build a city on his own hill. They quarrelled and during the fight Remus died.

Romulus named his new city Rome and became its first king in 753 BCE. But he needed people to live in his city, so he let slaves and criminals live there and stole women from the Sabine people, who lived in a nearby area. The Sabines declared war on Rome, but after a long battle, they agreed to join the kingdom of Romulus.

At the end of Romulus' life, Mars carried his son to the heavens, where he became a god called Quirinus.

- 1 What hill did Romulus live on? _____
- 2 What hill did Remus live on? _____
- 3 List two pieces of information found in the legend that match what historians believe about the beginnings of Rome. _____

- 4 Are legends based on fact or fiction? Explain your answer. _____

Objectives

- To identify, describe and compare two key groups in Ancient Roman society: the patricians and the plebeians
- To learn about dependency relationships and the laws of intermarriage
- To gain an overview of the Senate during the Republic, including who had the power to vote in elections and change laws
- To learn how a citizen might progress in a career through the Senate

Prior knowledge

Students should be aware that societies generally involve a social hierarchy of some sort, and that one's place in the hierarchy is determined by a range of factors, including birthplace, education, economic status and gender.

Background

The Roman Republic was the second in the sequence of Rome's governing bodies from kings to empire. It underpinned modern ideas of a democratic state by deliberately investing power in two leaders (*consuls*), giving the Senate a central role as powerbroker and administrator, and allowing its male citizens (*patricians* and *plebeians*) the right to vote for consuls, officials and laws.

During the Republic, Roman citizens could improve their social status. For a *plebeian* (average Roman citizen), having a patron from the *patrician* (noble) class offered an opportunity for advancement. Plebeians were allowed to marry patricians. However, plebeians lost their right to become senators by the end of the Republic.

The *pater familias* (eldest male in the family) was the lawful head of the household in both social groups. Women could not become Roman citizens.

Starter activity

Ask students to think about how someone today can change their own life for the better, for instance through education, work or exercising the right to vote. Does everyone in our society have the same opportunities in life? What makes it difficult for some people to improve their lives? What do students understand by the term 'social class'?

Resource and Activity sheets

The Resource sheet 'The Senate' develops student knowledge about the two key groups of citizens (patricians and plebeians) during the Republic, and their right to vote for leaders and change laws.

In the Activity sheet 'A career in the Senate', students consider how a male citizen might have advanced in a career through the Senate.

The Resource sheets 'Patricians' and 'Plebeians' each present the two citizenship classes in Ancient Rome through the eyes of a family member. In the Activity sheet 'Relationships in Roman society', students identify and describe the status of the *pater familias*, patronage and the law of intermarriage. They conclude their study of patricians and plebeians, by comparing their everyday life in the Activity sheet 'Plebeians and patricians'.

Extension activities

1 Hold a Roman-style mock election (placing a stone in a basket after crossing a bridge). Assign roles for students – patricians, plebeians, slaves, women, people from other places – and have them decide who may vote for two 'consuls' to represent the class.

2 With a partner, have students discuss how the following laws may have helped Ancient Romans to improve their social, political and economic standing in society.

- Some non-citizens of Rome can become citizens.
- A slave can become free.
- A plebeian can sometimes hold office or obtain titles in the army, trade, and in religion.

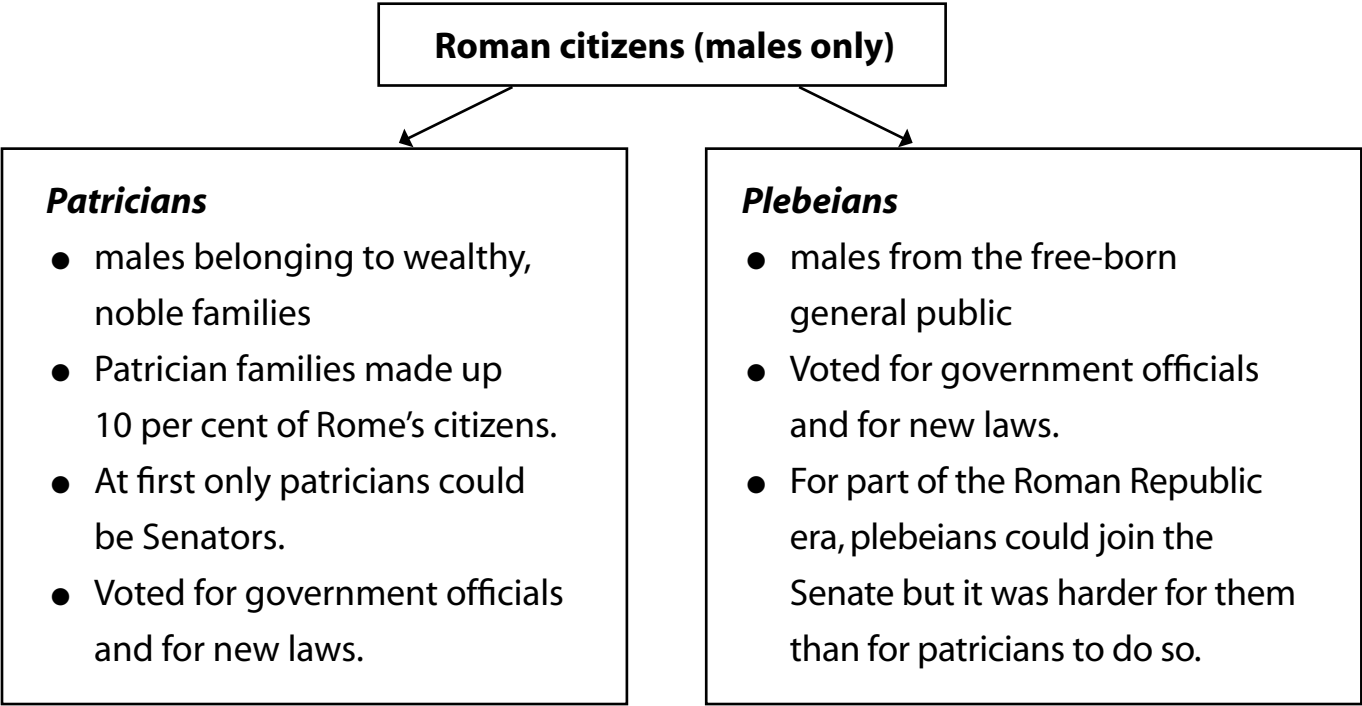
Answers

A career in the Senate **1** No; **2** No; **3** No; **4** Yes; **5** Yes; **6** (from bottom): protects; organises; judges; orders; rules; retires

Relationships in Roman society **1** patricians; **2** plebeians; **3** patron; **4** slave; **5** patricians, plebeians, slaves; **6** females, slaves; **7** father, grandfather

The Senate

- The Romans were ruled by kings from around 753 BCE to 510 BCE. Rome’s citizens did not want one person to have all the power, so they set up a new government, the **Roman Republic**, which lasted for over 400 years.
- The Roman Republic was governed by a group of people called the **Senate**. The most powerful men of Rome formed the Senate and were called **Senators**. They all had duties and jobs in the government, such as leading the army, looking after finances, being a judge or protecting citizens’ rights.
- Two elected **consuls** from the Senate were the rulers of Rome. They ruled for only one year each. Then they had to wait 10 years for another turn. During this time they retired and served as **pro-consuls** (governors) of other **provinces** (places ruled by Rome).
- Roman society at this time had two social classes of people: patricians and plebeians. Women, slaves and people from other places had no citizenship or voting rights.



-  1 Underline the title Romans gave to their two main leaders.
- 2 Circle the names of these two groups of Roman citizens: wealthy males from noble families and ordinary male Roman citizens.
- 3 Highlight which of these two groups had the most power.

A career in the Senate

 Circle 'Yes' or 'No' in answer to the following questions.

- 1

Could all the people in Rome become citizens?

Yes

No
- 2

Did all the people in Rome have the right to vote?

Yes

No
- 3

Did Roman women have equal rights?

Yes

No
- 4

Could plebeians vote for a new law?

Yes

No
- 5

Was a plebeian ever allowed to join the Senate during the Roman Republic?

Yes

No

Jobs in the Senate

6 Read the resource sheet 'The Senate', then use the verbs (doing words) in the text box to fill in the 'ladder to success' for a patrician in the Senate. Each rung of the ladder represents one of the jobs a patrician would carry out on their way to becoming consul or pro-consul.

Pro-consul _____ as governor of a province
(but can reapply every 10 years to be a consul again)

Consul _____ the Republic
as one of two leaders

Praetor _____ as a magistrate,
or _____ soldiers as a general

Aedile keeps law and order, looks after
health and _____ public games

Tribune

ordinary citizens' rights

Quaestor
helps with the finances

Military or law serves in the army or works
as a lawyer

protects

judges

orders

rules

organises

retires

Patricians

My family has been wealthy as long as we can remember. My grandfather says we can trace our noble family line back to the time of the kings. Grandfather is our **pater familias** (head of the household) because he is the oldest male in our family. Mother insists she has **authority** (power) over the home but she is really only in charge of the household slaves. Girls don't have much power.

Tonight we are holding a feast to celebrate my father being voted into the Senate as a **quaestor** (financial advisor). Members of all the leading noble families will dine with us. They are mostly Senators.

My father has been a **patron** to some wealthy tradespeople, giving them huge support and favours. They are also attending our feast tonight. My father says they are welcome here because Rome rewards hard work and ambition, but we have organised **inferior** (lower quality) food and wine for them, because of their lower status. Grandfather forbids them to be in the same room as him. He says they are 'plebeian upstarts'. Birth is important to grandfather. When I am older, he will only allow me to marry a patrician and not a plebeian, even though the law says I can.

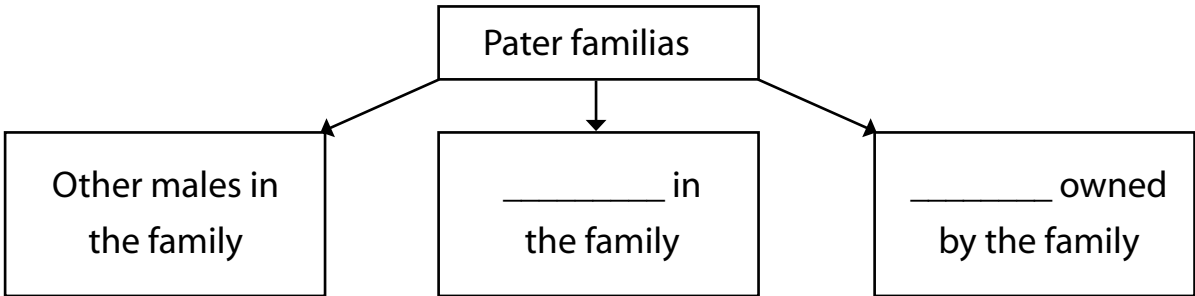
Tonight mother is going to wear all her finest jewellery. She has ordered the slaves to polish our beautiful mosaic tiled floors. The slaves are madly preparing nine courses of food. It's so boring having to wait until the poison taster has tried them all to see if they are safe for me to eat!

– Fortuna, daughter in the house of Lucius Domitius Maximus

Relationships in Roman society

- 👉 From the Resource sheet 'Patricians', find words with the following meanings:
- 1 Roman males from the upper class _____
 - 2 Ordinary free-born Roman men _____
 - 3 A Roman citizen of high rank who helps others improve their circumstances _____
 - 4 A non-citizen, owned by someone else _____
 - 5 Put the following groups in order of importance in Roman society from most important (A) to least important (C): slaves, patricians, plebeians
A _____ B _____ C _____

6 **Dependency relationships** (relationships used by the Romans to improve their social status) were an important feature of Ancient Roman life. Sometimes Ancient Roman laws established these relationships. Use the Resource sheet 'Patricians' to identify who was dependent on the **pater familias**.



- 7 Some patricians were against the rights of plebeians to better themselves in Ancient Roman society.
 - In Fortuna’s family who is against this idea? Fortuna’s _____
 - Who is for it? Fortuna’s _____
- 8 Will Fortuna ever be allowed to marry a plebeian? Why/why not?

Plebeians

We are a hardworking family. Father says we can hold our heads high, even if our tunics are plain and we live in a small flat. My father may only be a plebeian but he is a proud citizen of Rome. When I am older I, too, will become a citizen of Rome. I am sorry for mother and my sisters because they can never have citizenship, even though they are all free-born.

Father is our **pater familias**, the head of our household. He is a baker and works in the shop on the ground floor below our flat. I am a hard worker like my father and help him for long hours in the bakery. Father says before he dies he will own many slaves who will build a grand tomb for him.

My stomach is full from my breakfast of bread dipped in water. Mother even let me sprinkle raisins on the bread. I wondered why she was giving me such a treat and wearing her best jewellery made of painted clay.

‘Have you forgotten?’ she said, ‘Today is the **festival** (celebration) of Mars and Minerva. Later, we are to go to the Forum to see a juggler, just like the patricians will be doing!’

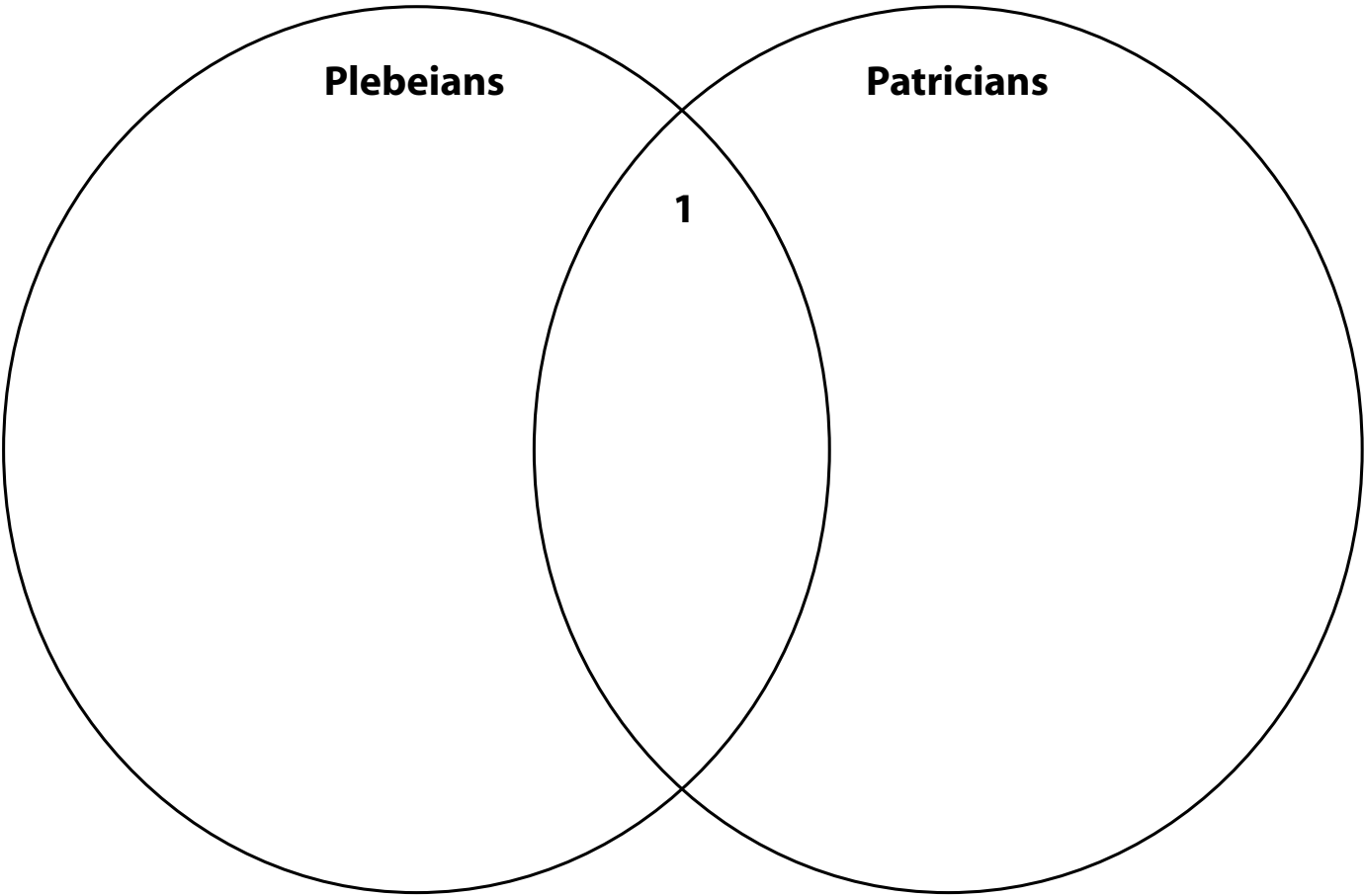
First she sends me off to collect some water from the public fountain.

Rome is a wonderful city. We can go to religious festivals, go to the Forum, even see gladiators fight at the amphitheatre. Who cares if the patricians get the best seats in the stadium!

– *Sebasta, son of the baker Drusus*

Plebeians and patricians

 1 Read the phrases in the box below. Place each phrase in the correct section of the diagram to show what things patricians and plebeians had in common, and which things were different for each class. The first one has been done for you.



- | | |
|--|-------------------------------|
| 1 Pater familias | 7 Non-citizenship for females |
| 2 Belonging to noble families | 8 Mosaic tiled floors |
| 3 Attending religious festivals | 9 Wear plain tunics |
| 4 Attending entertainment at the Forum | 10 Painted clay jewellery |
| 5 Best seats in an amphitheatre | 11 Working as tradespeople |
| 6 Citizenship for free-born males | 12 Joining the Senate |

Objectives

- To identify and describe Julius Caesar, a significant figure in the history of Ancient Rome
- To draw conclusions about how public opinion at the time was divided over his success as a ruler
- To identify and describe what happened as a result of his assassination

Prior knowledge

Students should have completed Unit 2 and be familiar with the Roman Republic and the social structure of Rome.

Background

Julius Caesar was a powerful general who won many important battles and formed alliances through a string of marriages and liaisons. Some of his greatest achievements as ruler of Rome were the introduction of the Julian Calendar and a law reform against extortion. However, he also made many enemies, particularly when he changed the way Rome was ruled. He was appointed dictator of Rome and by no longer allowing elections, he was able to appoint his favourites to senior offices. Romans were divided in their loyalties: some supported him, others thought he was a tyrant. After his murder by a group of Senators on 15 March (the Ides of March) 44 BCE, there were riots in the streets. Not long afterwards, Romans found themselves in the midst of a civil war.

Starter activity

Begin by having students find Italy, France (Gaul), Britain and Egypt on a map of the northern hemisphere. Identify the Rubicon, which formed the boundary between Gaul and Italy. Inform the students that these were significant places in the life of Julius Caesar. Make sure students know that Gaul is the old name for France.

Resource and Activity sheets

The Activity sheet 'A powerful general and leader' introduces students to the life of Julius Caesar. They then explore why the Senators committed their act of murder in the Activity sheet 'Caesar's murder'. Two historical sources are presented to students for student reflection.

The Activity sheet 'Caesar and Brutus' asks students to reflect on Caesar's career and Brutus' reasons for acting against him.

The Resource sheet 'Vox Pop (1)' presents Ancient Roman characters who reflect the divisions in popular opinion about the murder of Julius Caesar. In the Activity sheet 'Vox pop (2)', students then reflect on the range of opinions at the time and the consequences (civil war) of the political unrest set in motion by Julius Caesar's murder.

Extension activities

Have students choose one of the following sayings and research its meaning: 'Beware the Ides of March!', 'Veni Vidi Vici'. Can they guess what they mean? In what situations might these phrases be used? Students can use the internet or the library to research these further.

Imagine Brutus is being interviewed about his role in the murder of Julius Caesar. Have students work in pairs, with one as the interviewer asking the questions, and the other answering as Brutus. The interview should cover what happened, why Brutus took part, where the murder took place, how he felt when Caesar spoke to him in those final moments. Does Brutus have any regrets about what he and the other senators have done?

Answers

A powerful general and leader 2, 9, 4, 7, 6, 3, 5, 1, 8

Caesar's murder 1 The assassins have restored freedom to Rome. Julius Caesar is an enemy of Rome. March 15 is an important day in Rome's history. 2 Ides of March; Eid-Mar; 3 Suetonius. Roman coin.

Caesar and Brutus 1 Caesar became respected as a successful general by the people of Rome. 2 Caesar formed an alliance with two influential senators. 3 Marriage and important friends helped Caesar strengthen his connections. 4 Caesar defeated Pompey with a loyal army backing him. 5 Caesar increased his number of supporters in the Senate. 6 Because they thought he wanted to rule alone.

Vox pop (2) 2 dismiss[ed] his bodyguards; 3 riot; 4 civil war

A powerful general and leader

 1 Each of the words and phrases in the box has the same meaning as one of the underlined terms in the following passage. Write the number of the matching phrase in the brackets.

During the time of the Roman Republic () Gaius Julius Caesar became a powerful general and leader. He won many important battles, invading places such as Britain and Gaul ().

Always ambitious (), Caesar grew stronger by making important friends and through marriage ties. He formed an alliance with two influential () Senators, Crassus and Pompey. When Caesar was voted in as one of Rome’s consuls () he used his position to make his alliances stronger. However, the three men were often suspicious of one another. While Caesar was away fighting in Gaul, there were riots back in Rome. Pompey named himself dictator (). With Crassus killed in battle, Caesar broke all ties with Pompey.

Caesar’s army crossed the Rubicon (), and returned to Italy to start a war against Pompey. Caesar won the battle, and Pompey fled to Greece. Caesar was named ‘dictator’. He followed Pompey to Greece and defeated him. Pompey fled to Egypt, where he was killed by the Egyptians. Caesar’s power was now unchallenged (), and the Senate feared that he wanted too much power for himself.

During his rule, Caesar forgave many of his former enemies. He passed fairer tax reforms and laws. He introduced a 12-month calendar. The month Julius () was named after him. He had new buildings built in Rome.

By 44 BCE he had filled the Senate with supporters, who gave him the title ‘dictator for life’ – a life that was soon to be cut short by murder.



- 1

not threatened
- 2

time after the kings ruled Rome
- 3

sole ruler
- 4

determined to succeed
- 5

a river
- 6

leaders
- 7

powerful
- 8

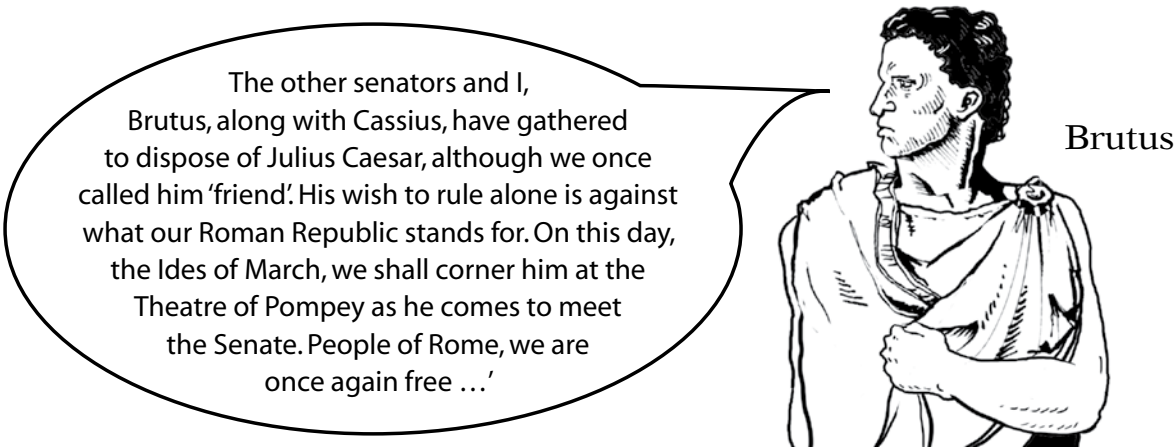
July
- 9

France

Caesar's murder

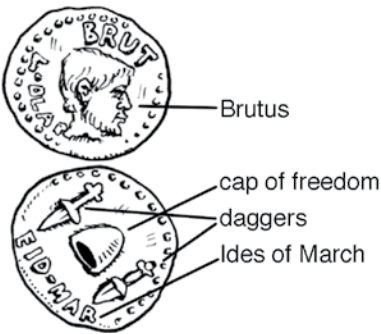
Julius Caesar was murdered on 15 March 44 BCE by a group of Senators who felt he held too much power. The night he was murdered, Caesar dismissed his bodyguards. Some people believe this shows he was overconfident.

An old friend of Caesar's, Marcus Junius Brutus, was one of the Senators who took part in the murder. According to the Roman historian Suetonius, 'Et tu, Brut, fili?' were the words spoken in **Latin** (the language spoken by Romans) by Julius Caesar on being stabbed by Brutus. This means 'And you, Brutus, son?' in English. Caesar felt betrayed that Brutus was among his killers.



 This Roman coin shows how the Senate portrayed Caesar's murder to the general public. Match these sentence fragments to describe the message the Senate was sending with this coin. An example has been given.

- | | | | | |
|-----------------|-------|---------------|-------|----------------------------------|
| Brutus | _____ | is an | _____ | freedom to Rome. |
| 1 The assassins | _____ | is an | _____ | important day in Rome's history. |
| 2 Julius Caesar | _____ | is a | _____ | enemy of Rome. |
| 3 March 15 | _____ | have restored | _____ | hero. |



- 4 Underline in red the words in Brutus' speech bubble that the Romans used for the date, March 15. On the coin, underline the Latin for these words.
- 5 Complete these sentences describing historical sources that tell us about Caesar's assassination.

The writing of Roman historian, _____, is an example of written evidence. The Roman _____ is an example of material evidence.

Caesar and Brutus

 Read the Activity sheet ‘A powerful general and leader’. Explain how Caesar was able to fulfil his ambition to become the most powerful man in Rome by rearranging these sentence fragments.

1 became respected as a successful general Caesar by the people of Rome.

2 with two influential Senators. Caesar formed an alliance

3 and important friends helped Caesar strengthen his connections. Marriage

Rearrange the following words to form complete sentences.

4 defeated Pompey backing him. Caesar with a loyal army

5 Caesar in the Senate. his number of supporters increased

Read about the murder of Caesar on the Activity sheets ‘A powerful general and leader’ and ‘Caesar’s murder’. Answer the following questions.

6 Why did the Senators decide to murder Caesar?

7 How do you think Caesar felt when he realised that Brutus was about to stab him?

Vox pop (1)

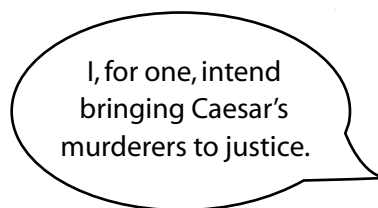
The term 'vox pop' comes from *vox populi*. This is Latin for 'voice of the people'.

What is your view on Julius Caesar's murder? We asked some of the people of Rome for their opinion ...



I think it's a fitting end to the tyrant's plans!

Cicero, Senator



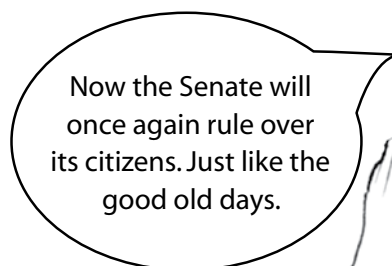
I, for one, intend bringing Caesar's murderers to justice.

Lepidus, General



Annia, woman from the house of Scipio

I heard Caesar knew there was going to be an ambush. So why did he dismiss his bodyguards?



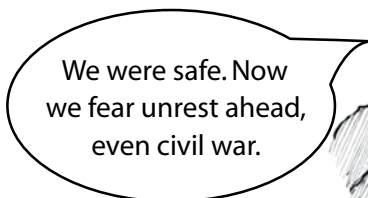
Now the Senate will once again rule over its citizens. Just like the good old days.

Galerius, Potter



Barbatus, Moneylender

If I was a senator, I would be asking, 'Will I be next?'



We were safe. Now we fear unrest ahead, even civil war.

Titus, Freedman, with Argentia, Freedwoman



I say let's riot! I call on all old soldiers who fought in Gaul to avenge Caesar's death.

Mamercus, Retired legionary

Vox pop (2)

 1 Using the Resource sheet ‘Vox pop (1)’, fill in the table with the names of the people surveyed and their job (for example, potter) or their status (for example, freedwoman). In the third column, write if they are *for* or *against* Julius Caesar. In the final column, write their reasons in your own words. An example has been given for you to follow.

Name	Job/Status	For or against?	Reason
Cicero	Senator	Against	Caesar wanted all the power for himself.

- 2 What did Caesar do on the day of his murder to show he was not afraid of facing his own death? _____
- 3 What did some people do on the streets of Rome when they heard about Julius Caesar’s murder? _____
- 4 What happened when others tried to seize power after Caesar’s death?
Rome had a c _ _ _ _ w _ _ .

Objectives

- To learn about the life of a Roman legionary and understand the strengths of the Roman army and how these led to their success in warfare
- To sequence some of the major battles and conquests from the Republic through to the fall of the western Roman Empire, and to locate empire strongholds on a map
- To understand how the Roman army helped to shape the known ancient world

Prior knowledge

Students should know that timelines can help them to sequence information and describe change or continuity over time.

Background

The Roman army is appreciated, not only as an integral part of the expansion, colonisation and building of the known ancient world, but for the legacy it left to the modern world. In the earlier days of the Roman Republic, soldiers were recruited for one battle at a time. After 107 BCE the army became a regular, long-term force. This professional army was led by senators of Rome as part of their duty to serve the people. The army continued to expand the Republic; then set about protecting Rome's provinces. Among their many other contributions to the ancient world, they built a vast network of roads. The army's main fighting unit was the highly organised, well-trained and disciplined *legion*.

Starter activity

Ask students why a country might have its own army. Record their answers (for example, to protect people and borders, to conquer) for referral throughout the unit. Ask them why they think the Roman army is still remembered? They can check their predictions as they work on the unit.

Resource and Activity sheets

The resources and activities in this unit provide a basic introduction to the life of a Roman *legionary* (foot soldier). The Resource sheets 'A Roman legion' and 'Uniform, weapons and training' cover some of the factors that contributed to the success of the Roman army, most notably its organisation and the superiority of Roman weaponry and disciplined training techniques. Students reflect on these in the Activity sheet 'An organised fighting unit'.

Students then identify and describe the requirements and lifestyle of a legionary in the Activity sheet 'Join a Roman legion!', finishing with a timeline in the Activity sheet 'Major wars and conquests'.

Extension activities

Have students imagine that they are a young legionary stationed at an outpost far from Rome. Have them write a letter home to their family, letting them know which legion they are in and describing their daily life. What is different to life in Rome? What would they like sent to them from home?

Consider in what ways the Roman army was well organised. As a class, discuss how the Roman army was able to invade so many countries and remain undefeated for a long time. Use these words as prompts: better weapons, well-organised, self-sufficient, good equipment, fit and healthy.

Answers

An organised fighting unit sandal; red tunic; spade; food and cooking pot; iron nails; gladius; wicker basket; pilium; shields; armour

Major wars and conquests 1 Spain, Gaul; 2 Britain; 3 Dacia



A Roman legion

The main fighting unit of the Roman army was the **legion**. Each legion had about 5000 to 6000 soldiers, called **legionaries**. The legionaries formed strong, disciplined units. Their commanding officer was called a **legate**.

On average during the Roman Empire, there were about 30 legions. At its largest, the Roman army had over 500 000 legionaries. The legions were so well organised and well trained that the army became almost unstoppable.

 1 Fill in the missing numbers in the 'Organisation of a roman legion' diagram below.

Organisation of a Roman legion

1 legion of 6000 soldiers divides into __ **cohorts**.

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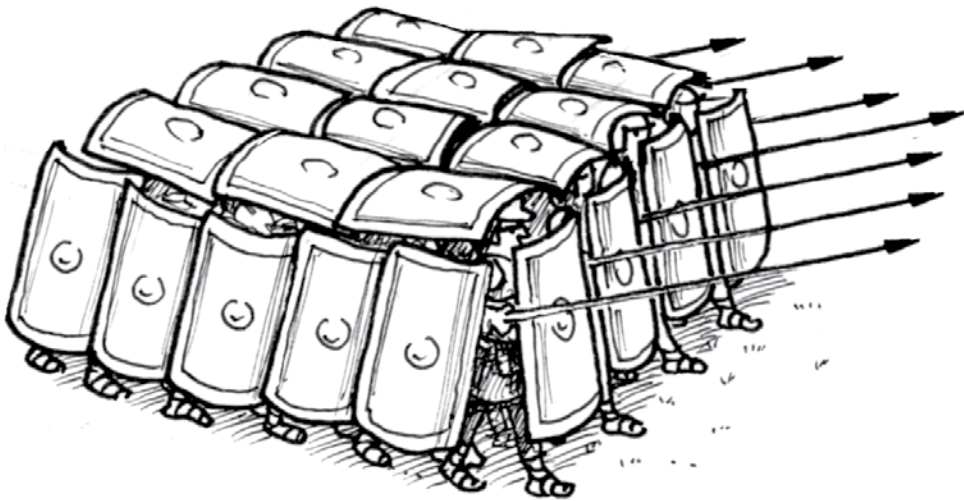
1 cohort of 600 soldiers divides into __ **centuries**.

100	100	100	100	100	100
-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----

Each century of 100 soldiers divides into __ **contubernium**.

--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--	--

The size of each legion meant they could defend themselves easily against attacks. The **testudo** (tortoise) defence protected soldiers and helped them to advance on their enemy. In this formation, legionaries locked their shields together on all sides and also held them above their heads.



Uniform, weapons and training

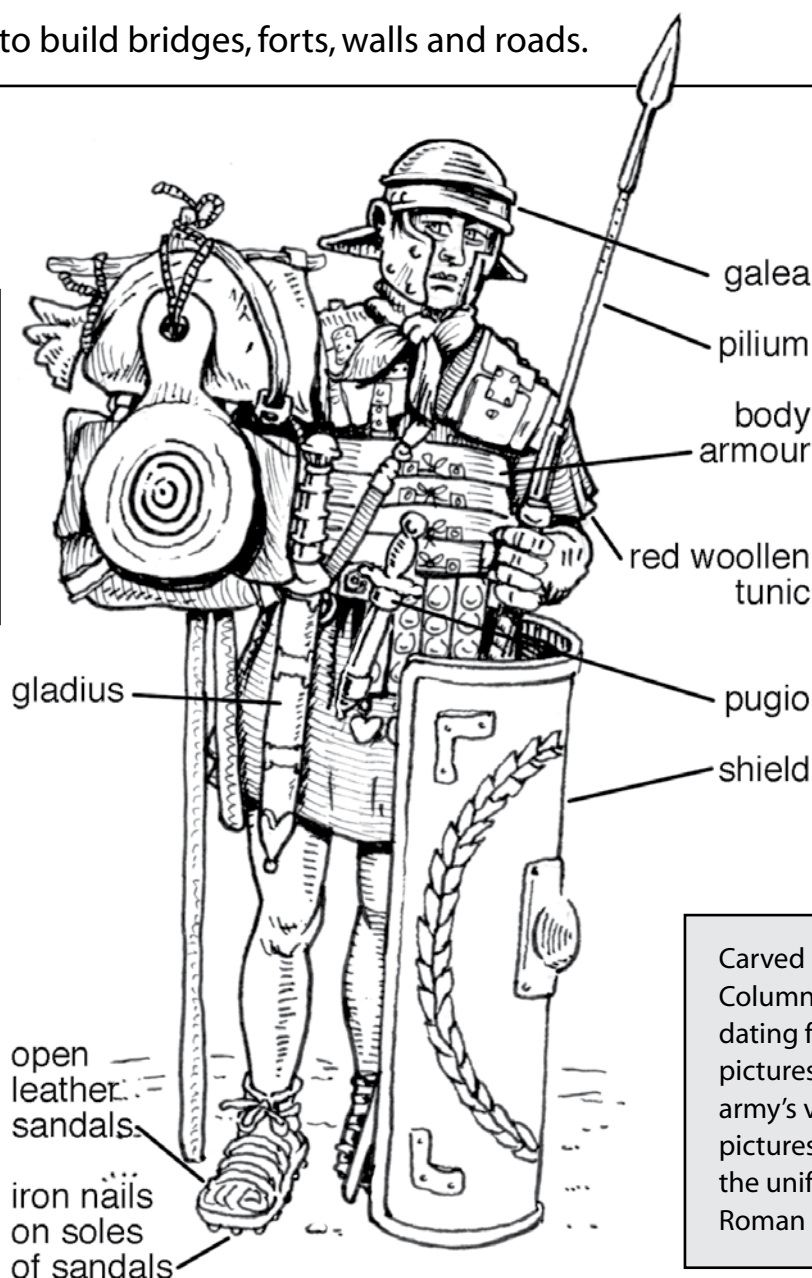
Legionaries each carried their own kit, containing a cooking pot, food, a spade, an axe or saw and a wicker basket.

Training

To train to be a legionary, soldiers had to:

- march for up to 30 kilometres a day while wearing armour and carrying equipment
- do weapons drills twice a day
- train in one-on-one combat
- learn how to swim
- learn how to build bridges, forts, walls and roads.

The gladius was a short stabbing sword. It was easier, more precise and faster to use than the longer swords used by enemy armies.



The pilum was a throwing spear with a sharp point, which would bend and stick in the enemy's shield on impact. It was very difficult to pull out, so the enemy couldn't reuse it.

Carved in the stone of Trajan's Column (a tall, stone pillar dating from Rome, 114 CE) are pictures of some of the Roman army's victories. From these pictures, we have learnt about the uniform and weapons of a Roman legionary.

An organised fighting unit

-  1 Use the Resource sheet ‘Uniform, weapons and training’ to complete the table. Choose the term from the word list that best fits each of the descriptions given below.

shields	iron nails	red tunic
gladius	wicker basket	food and cooking pot
sandal	pilium	
spade	armour	

Object	Description
Sandal	The open leatherwork keeps feet healthy.
	The colour of this garment won't show blood and puts fear into the enemy.
	A legionary uses this to dig trenches and build roads.
	This means a legionary can feed himself if the going gets tough.
	Nailed onto the leather, these keep the soles tough.
	The design makes this weapon faster to use.
	This is a useful item for carrying earth or small rocks when building road, forts and walls.
	When this is thrown and becomes stuck, the enemy soldier can no longer use his own shield.
	On level ground, soldiers can stand in a line to make a fighting wall with these.
	A legionary wears this while covering 30 kilometres a day, three times per week, in readiness for warfare and to keep fit.

Join a Roman legion!



Job for life ♦ Retirement plan
Travel opportunities ♦ Learn a trade
Equipment provided ♦ Some conditions do apply*



* 1 Must be unmarried. 2 Must be at least 1.6 metres tall and 20 years of age. 3 Work contract lasts for 25 years. 4 Free medical care. 5 Yearly pay rate: 300 denarii. 6 Cash bonus and land at the end of a contract. 7 Some pay kept for food, uniform, weapons and pension plan. 8 Hard physical work required. Stonemasons should apply. 9 Long hours. 10 Some danger is involved. 11 Severe penalties (slavery or crucifixion) apply for breaking a work contract early.

 1 Read the conditions that apply for a job in the Roman army. In your own words, explain what the features mentioned in the main advertisement are offering.

Features	What’s on offer
Job for life	25 years of army service. If you survive that long!
Good work conditions	
Pay	
Retirement plan	
Travel opportunities	
Learn a trade	
Equipment provided	

2 Imagine you are going to apply to join the Roman Army as a legionary. In your workbook, write one reason why you would be perfect for the job.

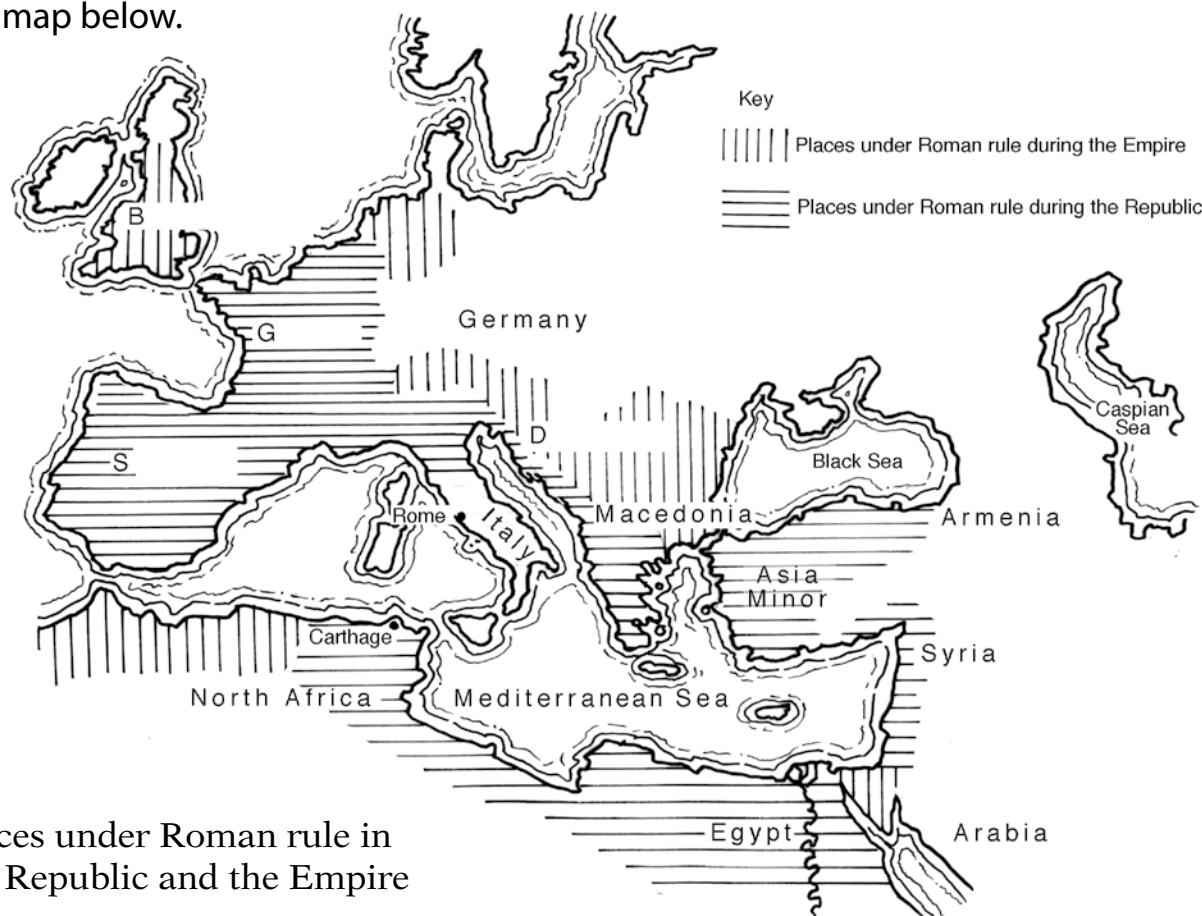
Major wars and conquests

With the strength of its army, Rome grew from a **Republic** into a vast **empire**, ruling over Britain, all of western Europe, from modern Turkey (Asia Minor) to Armenia, northern Africa and the Mediterranean islands.

☞ The timeline to the right lists the major battles that the Roman army fought throughout its history. Read the timeline, then complete the following questions.

- 1 Which two countries were conquered by the Roman Republic, between 509 and 52 BCE?
- 2 Which country was conquered by the Roman Empire in 43 CE?
- 3 Where did the Romans fight in the early 100s CE?
- 4 Fill in the missing labels on the map below.

Timeline	
509 BCE	Rome becomes a Republic .
215 BCE	First Macedonian war.
148 BCE	Fourth and final Macedonian war.
133 BCE	Spain is conquered.
66–62 BCE	Battles in Asia.
58 BCE	Battles in Gaul.
52 BCE	Julius Caesar defeats Vercingetorix in Gaul.
47 BCE	Julius Caesar invades Egypt.
29 BCE	Augustus is the first emperor of the Roman Empire .
43 CE	Conquest of Britain.
68 CE	Conquest of Arabia.
101–106 CE	Wars in Dacia.
476 CE	Fall of Western Roman Empire.



Places under Roman rule in the Republic and the Empire

Objectives

- To gain an understanding of some examples of diversity and differences between key groups (Roman citizens, freedmen, women, slaves)
- To identify and describe some examples of their rights and freedoms
- To draw some conclusions about the prevailing Roman values and experience in relation to slavery and freedom

Prior knowledge

Students should know that in ancient times not all people had equal rights and that this remains the case in many societies today.

Background

In order to understand the nature of a society, it is important to look at its values. The Romans had a hierarchy of citizenship down to slavery. On all rungs, the status of a female was inferior to a male. Ancient Rome could not have grown so rapidly without its vast industry of slaves, who were used for building, food production and in all facets of daily life.

Romans did believe that a slave could be set free. They recognised these freed slaves as a class (freedman and freedwoman) and in law.

Starter activity

Ask students to brainstorm their responses to these questions: What are human rights? What does it mean to be free? Does slavery still happen today? Ask them to discuss the fact that 50 per cent of all females in the world today are illiterate.

Resource and Activity sheets

In the Resource sheet 'Free-born citizens' students identify and consider the differing rights of diverse groups in Ancient Rome, before reading about the experiences of being 'Slaves'. Through the Activity sheet 'Slave or free?' and 'A slave's work' they focus on the various work duties required of a slave, and interpret what it meant to be a free-born citizen, slave, or freedman/woman in Roman times.

The Romans did believe a slave could be set free. The final activity 'Free at last' asks students to reflect on the likelihood of this happening.

Extension activities

Slavery still exists today in some parts of the modern world. Students could research an example of contemporary slavery, such as child soldiers, cocoa harvesters in Africa or garment industry workers in India. As a class, discuss why slavery still exists. What actions could be taken to stop it? You could extend this discussion to include women's illiteracy.

As a class, consider the following questions and hold a discussion.

- Why do you think voting is considered such an important right to have?
- How do you think Ancient Romans justified men having more rights than women?

Answers

A slave's work 4, 3, 1, 2, 5



Free-born citizens

Ancient Romans did not believe that everyone had equal rights. The biggest difference between people was whether they were free or slaves. Men who were born free were called **free-born citizens**. No women were citizens. Women had few legal rights and were not allowed to vote.

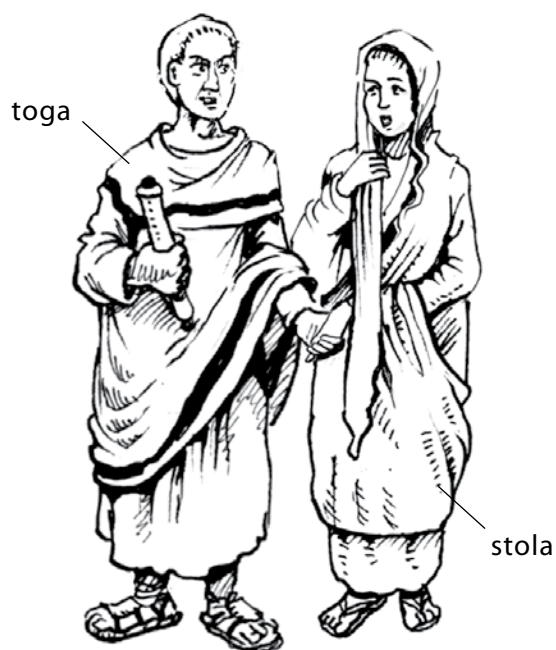
Free-born citizens could:

- choose their own work
- marry
- travel from one place to another
- vote for the government
- receive some free food from the government
- go to the gladiator games
- go to the public baths
- have lots of free time
- be protected by law.

 **1** Which of the above would you most value if you were a free-born Roman citizen.

Clothing

- Only free-born male citizens could wear a **toga** (a long, semi-circular cloak). Until he was 16, a free-born boy wore a toga with a purple stripe.
- **Plebeian** (ordinary class) men wore a plain white **toga virilis** (toga of manhood).
- **Patrician** (noble class) men wore one with a stripe.
- Free-born women wore a **stola** (floor-length dress), which covered their under-tunic.



Not all the people who lived in Rome were free-born citizens. Roman law allowed anyone to come and live in the city, but they had to support themselves. Later, people across the Roman Empire could buy Roman citizenship. **Freedmen** and **freedwomen** were people who had been set free from slavery, but they had fewer rights than free-born citizens. Again, men had more rights than women.

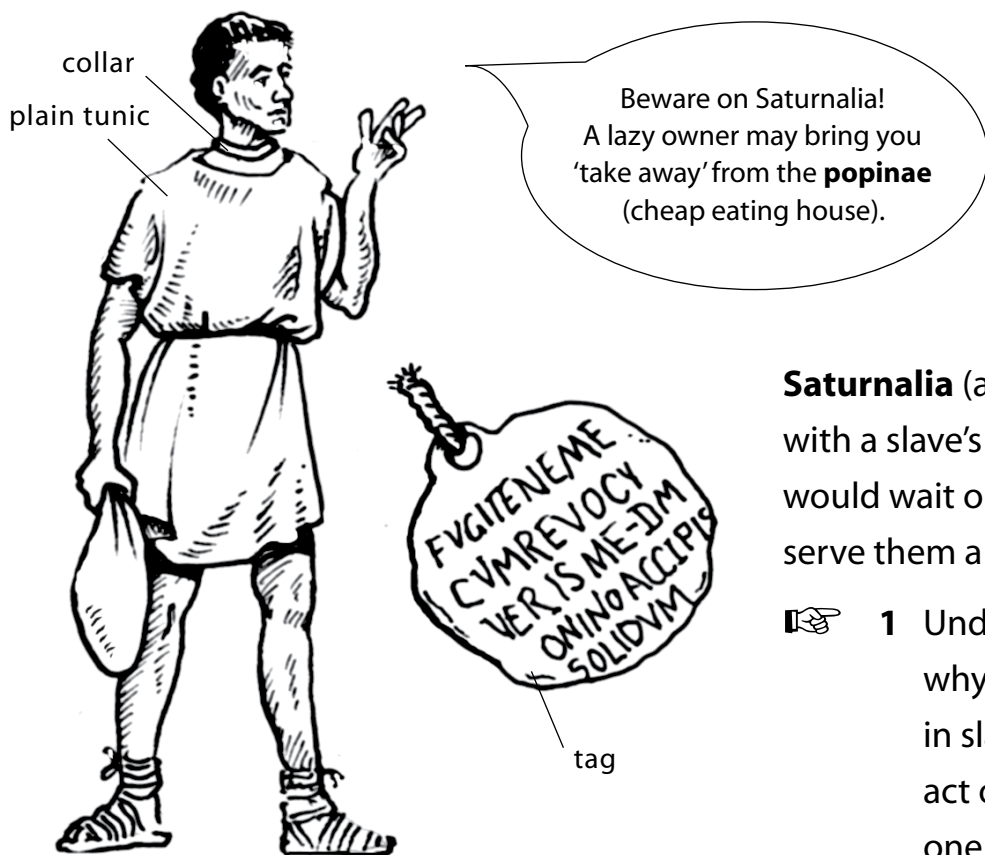
Slaves

In Ancient Rome, people did not believe that everyone was equal. Almost everyone accepted the use of slaves. Slaves were owned by other people and had no rights. They worked for little or no reward. A slave might be:

- a criminal who committed a serious crime
- a prisoner taken in war
- a person from another land who was kidnapped and sold by slave traders
- a poor person who sold himself or herself into slavery
- a child born to slaves.

The use of slaves helped Rome become **wealthy**. Slaves did a lot of work for a very low cost. They carried out all the farming to produce food or goods. Slaves that could read and write (often Greeks) became doctors or scribes. Many gladiators were slaves. Slaves lived with the families that owned them. One senator had over 4000 slaves.

Slaves wore simple clothes. Sometimes their owners made them wear a type of uniform. Some were branded, or wore a tag with their owner’s name on it in case they escaped.



Saturnalia (a mid-winter festival) ended with a slave’s holiday. A kind slave owner would wait on the family’s slaves and serve them a special feast on this day.

- 1 Underline in blue two reasons why Ancient Romans believed in slavery. Underline in red one act of a kind slave owner and one of a cruel owner.

Slave or free?

 1 Read the comments below. Tick whether each was made by a **free-born** person or a **slave**. One of these people is neither free-born nor a slave – they are a **freedman** or **freedwoman**. Can you find this person?

Comment	Free-born citizen	Slave
Mercy! After 20 years of hard work here in the fields I am to be sent to work in the mines.		
My kidnapper has cut off my beautiful blonde hair. It is to be sold to Rome, like me, and will be made into a wig for a Roman lady.		
My owner trusts me. He values my skills. If I continue to show him I am loyal, one day he may let me go.		
My name is Marcus Tuillius Cicero and I say, 'Trades involving physical labour are unsuitable for a gentleman.'		
Because of this gift from my master on his deathbed, I am now able to set up a business of my own.		
I am a poor citizen but I will not go hungry, for the government will give me some food.		
Bring me my toga! Not the striped one, I am much too grown up for that. Bring the newly woven white one.		
I wear a special tag with my master's name and address written on it. I dare not run away, for I will easily be caught and returned.		
Although I work long hours for no money, I am treated well. I feel like I am part of the family.		
Because a slave hurt our mistress, we are all to be punished.		

A slave’s work

Slaves worked long hours for their owners. Some owners trusted them and valued their labour and skills. Others treated them harshly. If a slave harmed his owner, all the slaves in the house could be executed.

1 I always travel with the Roman commander. I must see to the commander’s every need but at least I get to see the world!

2 I am to serve a big feast here this evening: dormice in honey sprinkled with poppy seeds, wild boar with live thrush, peppered figs or honey cake.

3 I was taken from Greece. Now I advise the soldiers on exercise and what to eat. I treat them with herbs. Sometimes I must operate. Life could be much worse for me.

4 Another victorious win in the Colosseum! Some day soon I may be able to buy my way out of bondage. If not, and I grow old here, I will be tossed to the lions.

5 I am free after 26 years of loyal service. My former owner pays me to manage all his slaves on the farm estate.

 1 Complete the table with the number of the slave that best fits each ‘Who am I?’ description.

Who am I?	Slave number
I am a gladiator. I fight other gladiators or wild animals to entertain the crowds.	4
I am a doctor. I serve in the army.	
I am an officer’s slave. I work throughout the empire.	
I am a house slave. I prepare or serve the day’s meals.	
I am an estate manager. I manage the slaves on a country estate.	

2 Why do you think someone would sell himself or herself into slavery?

Free at last

Sometimes slaves could earn their freedom. Their owners may free them. Some even became rich from kind owners who gave them **peculia** (money gifts).

-  1 What gift might a slave owner who was on his deathbed have given to a slave?
-
- 2 This table lists other ways a slave could be set free. For each way, write one thing that could go wrong. Two examples have been given.

Way to become free	Obstacle (problem)
be loyal to my owner	My owner depends on me and will not set me free.
work hard	
go to gladiator school, win fights	
be successful in the Roman army	
buy my way out of slavery	
dying owner may show mercy	
escape	
wage war against the Roman army	Like many in the slave army who followed Spartacus* in his revolt against Rome, I may be captured and crucified.

- 3 If you were a slave, which way would you try to become free? Underline your first choice. Then explain why to a partner.

* **Spartacus** was a famous gladiator who led a revolt in southern Italy between 73 and 71 BCE. 90 000 slaves joined him. He killed many Roman soldiers before being defeated in battle. To stop others following him, 6000 slaves from Spartacus’ army were crucified along the Via Appia (Rome’s first major road).

Objectives

- To identify and describe what it was like to be a gladiator
- To develop knowledge about the beliefs and values of Ancient Romans by considering the popularity and extent of their gladiator contests
- To sequence how Roman attitudes and laws about gladiator combat changed over time
- To describe some of the consequences of Roman gladiator combat on the wildlife in the known ancient world

Prior knowledge

Students should have an understanding of what is considered popular entertainment today.

Background

For all its sophistication and intelligence, Roman life had a side that was very brutal to our modern sensitivities. People valued the art of killing and gloried in savage blood sports such as the gladiatorial games. These contests date back to 264 BCE as funeral matches to honour dead family members. Designed and often sponsored by the state as entertainment for the populace, gladiator contests attracted hundreds of thousands of spectators. One theory about their popularity is that because most Ancient Romans could not expect to live beyond 30, they felt it was important to meet death with glory and dignity. In a society based on the strength and courage of its army as a military force, the government may have wished to teach its citizens how to use combat and face death. As hard as it is for us to imagine, watching gladiators die 'well' was a way to achieve this goal. Gladiators did rebel at times, one famous example being Spartacus. Towards the end of the empire, changing attitudes led to the eventual ban of gladiator sports by the emperor Honorius.

Starter activity

Ask students what they associate with the word 'gladiator'. Discuss how the word is used today. Discuss why we find it hard today to understand how gladiator games could be accepted. Discuss modern examples of controversial sports such as Spanish bullfighting or foxhunts. How do students feel about these?

Resource and Activity sheets

The Resource sheet 'Gladiator combat' and the Activity Sheet 'Gladiator FAQ' provide an overview of the topic.

The Activity sheet 'Wild animals in the arena' gives students an opportunity to describe Roman attitudes about wild animals and consider the long-term effects on the animal world.

The Activity sheet 'Secutor's fan club' asks them to summarise, in interview form, the life of a gladiator.

The Activity sheet 'Changing attitudes' asks students to revise how attitudes to gladiatorial combat changed over time, and to think about how these values and beliefs compare with those of today. They should refer to the Resource sheet 'Gladiator combat' to complete the flowchart.

Extension activity

Ask students how we can make sense of the Ancient Romans' enjoyment of human blood sports? Have them recall what they discussed in the starter activity. Have their views changed? What do other sports such as wrestling and boxing have in common with the gladiator games? Finish by deciding on a set of values that today's society holds with regards to modern sports.

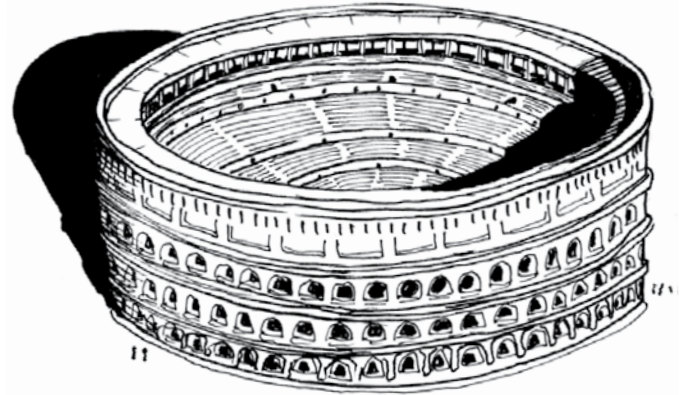
Answers

Wild animals in the arena Asia Minor (Turkey): tiger, leopard; Numidia (North Africa): rhinoceros, elephant; Aegyptus (Egypt): hippopotamus; Hibernia (Ireland): wolf; Caledonia (Scotland): bear; Mesopotamia (Iraq): lion

Gladiator combat

The word **gladiator** means swordsman. It comes from the Latin word for sword: **gladius**. Most gladiators were prisoners of war, slaves or condemned criminals. They were expected to fight to the death in bloody combat against:

- other gladiators
- other criminals, slaves or prisoners of war
- people Romans considered to be a threat (for example, Christians and Jews)
- wild animals.



The Colosseum

Arena is Latin for sand. An arena was a place filled with sand to soak up the blood spills. After each contest the arena was freshly raked. Later, slaves built bigger arenas, or **amphitheatres**, to house the growing crowds. The Flavian Amphitheatre was also called the **Colosseum**. With room for over 250 000 people, it was the largest arena, built in the middle of Rome. The ruins of the Colosseum are now a popular tourist attraction.

- The first gladiator match was set up in a cattle market to honour a man who had just died.
- Then it became common for gladiators to fight at funeral games or to honour the gods in public spaces, such as market squares.
- As time went on, gladiators fought in arenas, to please the emperor and entertain the huge crowds who came to watch them.
- Gladiator events were often held on public holidays, when gladiators fought to the death to honour their gods.
- A morning contest might be animal fights, or people versus big cats.
- During lunch came clowns and public executions.
- Sometimes the arena was flooded for spectacular sea battles.
- Single combat events between popular gladiators took place as main events, or over many days of gladiator game, such as the Colosseum games in 100 CE.
- After hundreds of years, Emperor Honorius decides that gladiator combat is too cruel and stops it. The Colosseum closes.

Gladiator FAQ

How do we know about gladiators?

Ancient Roman pictures of gladiators still exist today. Some are on mosaic tiles. Others are carvings or paintings.

Could women be gladiators?

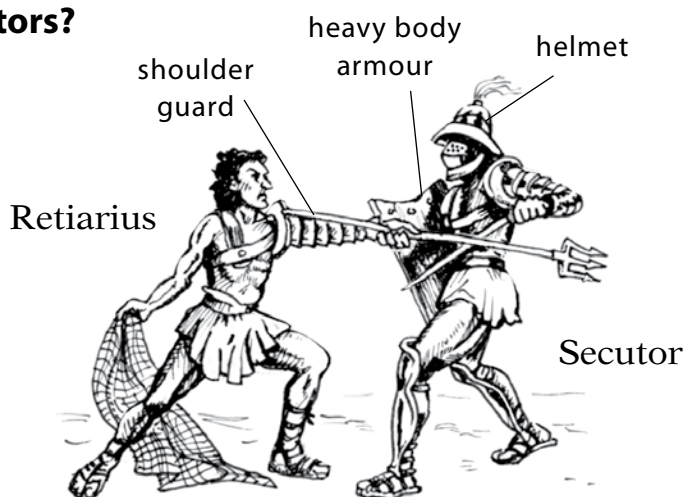
Yes. Most of the discoveries show gladiators were male. However, one stone tablet shows two female gladiators fighting with daggers. The Roman poet, Juvenal, left a nasty poem about women gladiators, saying they were a disgrace!

Were there many different types of gladiators?

Yes. Two examples were the **secutor**, who was heavily armed, and the **retiarius**, a net-fighter who wore little armour and relied on being fit and fast.

What happened to a wounded gladiator?

When the crowd pointed their thumbs down at a wounded gladiator, this meant 'no mercy'. Some slaves came out into the arena dressed in masks. One carried a **mallet** (hammer) to strike the injured gladiator a final blow, while another slave dragged away the body. Lucky gladiators lived to fight another day.



- 1 Underline the words above naming three historical sources that tell us what gladiators looked like.
- 2 Use the words in the box to finish labelling the pictures of the retiarius and secutor gladiators.

gladius (short stabbing sword)	weighted net
trident (three-pronged spear)	oblong shield

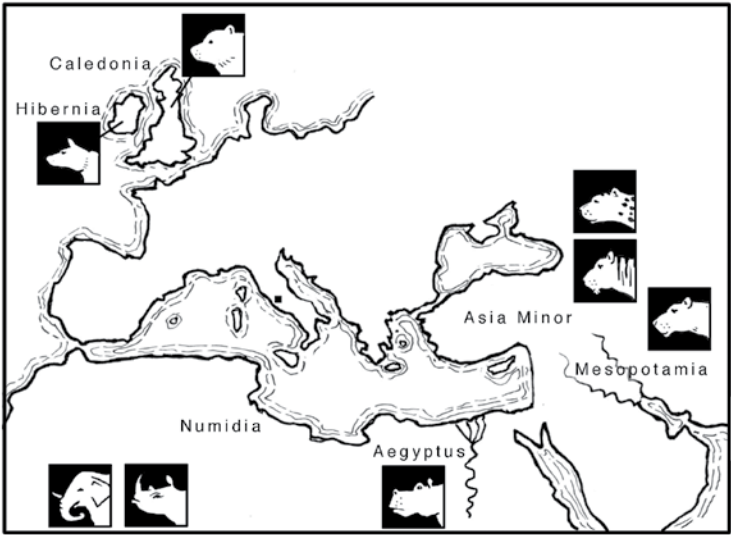
Read the Resource sheet 'Gladiator combat' then answer these questions in your workbook.

- 3 Who were the gladiators?
- 4 Where did the gladiators fight?

Wild animals in the arena

Thousands of wild animals were captured for gladiator contests. The Romans took these animals from countries around the empire. Some countries became very wealthy because of this export trade.

-  1
- In the table below, join the animals with the countries they lived in before they were captured for gladiator contests. Using a modern atlas, complete the table with the modern names for these countries.



Where some of the wild animals came from

Animal	Country (Ancient Roman name)	Country (modern name)
 lion	Asia Minor	
 hippopotamus	Numidia	
  leopard & tiger	Aegyptus	
 bear	Hibernia	
  elephant & rhinoceros	Caledonia	
 wolf	Mesopotamia	

- 2
- Write about the effects of the Ancient Roman’s enjoyment of watching wild animals fight to the death:
- on some towns in the Roman Empire
 - on the wildlife of the time.

Secutor's fan club

Imagine you are one of the Colosseum's greatest and most popular gladiators, the **secutor** (heavily-armed gladiator) Sentinus Baccibus. An adoring fan wants to know more about you.

 Answer the questions she puts to you. You can use the boxed words for ideas.



1 How many wins have you had so far?

2 Why did you become a gladiator?

3 How did you feel after your first fight?

4 What are your favourite weapons?

5 What is it like to fight wild animals?

6 What is the most impressive show you've ever fought in?

7 Do you have any plans for the future?

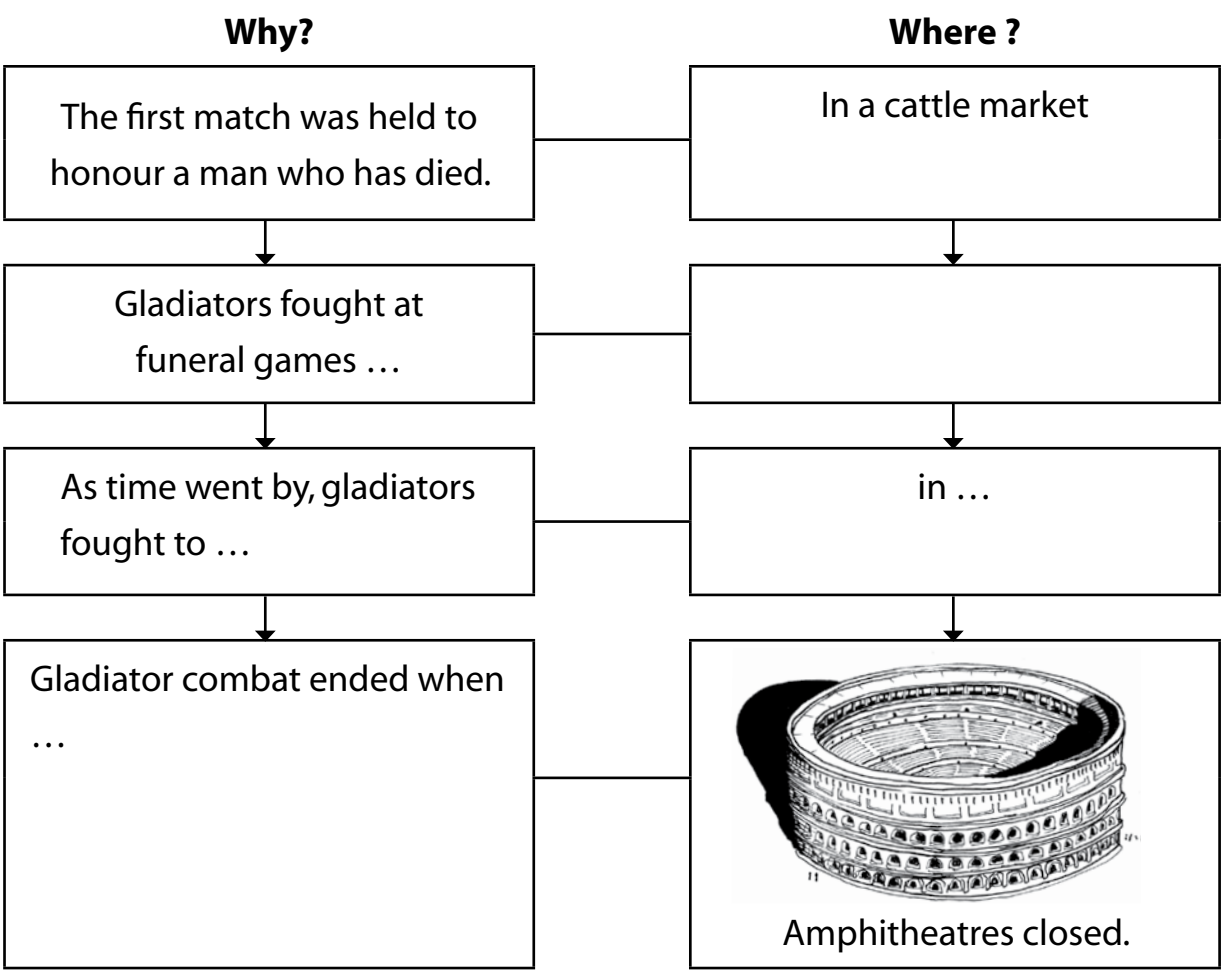
8 Will you autograph my papyrus scroll?

9 In your workbook, write two sentences of the secutor's journal. Describe his greatest wish.

criminal, slave, prisoner of war, win prize money
scared, relieved, happy
gladius, shield
lions, wolves, bears, rhinoceroses
army or navy battle, animal fight
wealth, freedom, survival

Changing attitudes

-  1 Use the Resource sheet 'Gladiator combat' to fill in the missing parts of the flowchart about how gladiator games and attitudes towards them changed over time.



- 2 Complete the following table by describing what Ancient Romans may have thought about the following things, and about what we believe today.

Beliefs about...	in Ancient Rome	today
what is entertaining		
fights to the death		
killing wild animals		
punishing people		
people considered a threat to the community		

Objectives

- To sequence the stages of the eruption of Vesuvius in 79 CE and describe the impact on Pompeii
- To identify and describe examples of scientific and written evidence used to provide historical information about Pompeii and its inhabitants
- To describe some aspects of Pompeian daily life
- To draw conclusions about how Pompeii is a unique example of 'preserved history'

Prior knowledge

Students should have a basic understanding of what archaeology is. They should also understand the concept of cause and effect.

Background

The catastrophic volcanic explosion at Pompeii in 79 CE resulted in the town being preserved through the ages. Historical inquiry began with the first archaeological discovery at the site and subsequent record keeping, moving on to the present era of intense preservation and conservation. Today, 60 per cent of the town is uncovered. World citizens are fortunate to be able to stroll through this unique open-air museum and observe evidence of what life was like for Pompeians at the time Mount Vesuvius erupted. However, the need for constant upkeep of Pompeii was made apparent in late 2010, when several walls of the town collapsed.

Starter activity

Ask students what they know about volcanic eruptions. Locate Mount Vesuvius and Pompeii on a map of Italy.



Resource and Activity sheets

The Resource sheet 'Pompeii is buried' gives an overview of the disaster, and then explains how the town came to be rediscovered and preserved. Once students have read this information, get them to complete the Activity sheet 'Mount Vesuvius erupts', where they sequence the key stages of the volcanic eruption and its effect on Pompeii.

In the Activity sheet 'A personal view of Pompeii' students read a recount from Pliny the Younger. They are then asked to complete an empathy task, in which they imagine being an eyewitness to the destruction of Pompeii. You could extend this activity further by holding a class discussion about modern disasters and the emotional effects on survivors and rescuers.

The Resource sheet 'Pompeii casts' explains how Fiorelli's method of using plaster casts has contributed to the ongoing scientific preservation and conservation of Pompeii. In the Activity sheet 'Daily life in Pompeii', students imagine and interpret the daily lives of these Ancient Pompeians based on what has been found and preserved.

Finally, in 'Cause and effect' students sum up the knowledge they have gained in the unit, before reflecting on what they would do if faced with a similar disaster.

Extension activities

Make a class collage of pictures from Pompeii showing structures, artefacts and plaster casts. Find them on the internet or in textbooks. Some websites allow you to go for a virtual walk around Pompeii. Students could also find out about Herculaneum, the other town buried by Vesuvius.

Develop an emergency plan for surviving different stages of a volcanic eruption, from early warnings to the final stages when there is little chance of escape.

Answers

Mount Vesuvius erupts 2 and 5, 3, 4, 1

Daily life in Pompeii Her clothing suggests she may be poor or a slave. He tries to guard her face from the toxic gases. Maybe she is with her family; This is a slave's room in the slave quarters section of the home. The seal on the ring shows that the slave is owned by Quintus Poppaeus. He is keeping the money purse close by and plans to stay safe in his bed until the danger passes; The gladiators train at this gladiator school. Their armour must have been kept in a room upstairs.

Pompeii is buried

Around noon on 24 August 79 CE, a loud bang came from Mount Vesuvius. A spout of dark ash rose up from the mountain. It formed a thick cloud, blotting out the sun and blowing towards the south. Day instantly turned to night.

- For nineteen hours, **pyroclastic material** (ash, pumice and gases) rained onto the coastal town of Pompeii, 10 kilometres away from the volcano.
- Modern experts estimate that 2000 out of the town's 20 000 inhabitants stayed, while others fled. Intense heat overpowered the people who remained behind. Deadly gases choked them.
- The mountain dome collapsed, and the town was completely buried by ash. Everything – humans, animals, buildings and objects – was covered.
- For nearly 1700 years, Pompeii remained hidden. **Archaeologists** began **excavating** Pompeii in 1748, but scientific records were only kept from 1864. So far, 60 per cent of the town has been recovered.
- This was not the first time disaster struck Pompeii. At the time Vesuvius erupted, many buildings still lay in ruins or were under repair from an earthquake 17 years earlier.
- Before the eruption, Pompeii was 500 metres from the sea. Volcanic ash and rubble filled the bay. Now, it is two kilometres inland. Today the ruins are a vast, open-air museum visited by tourists from all around the world.

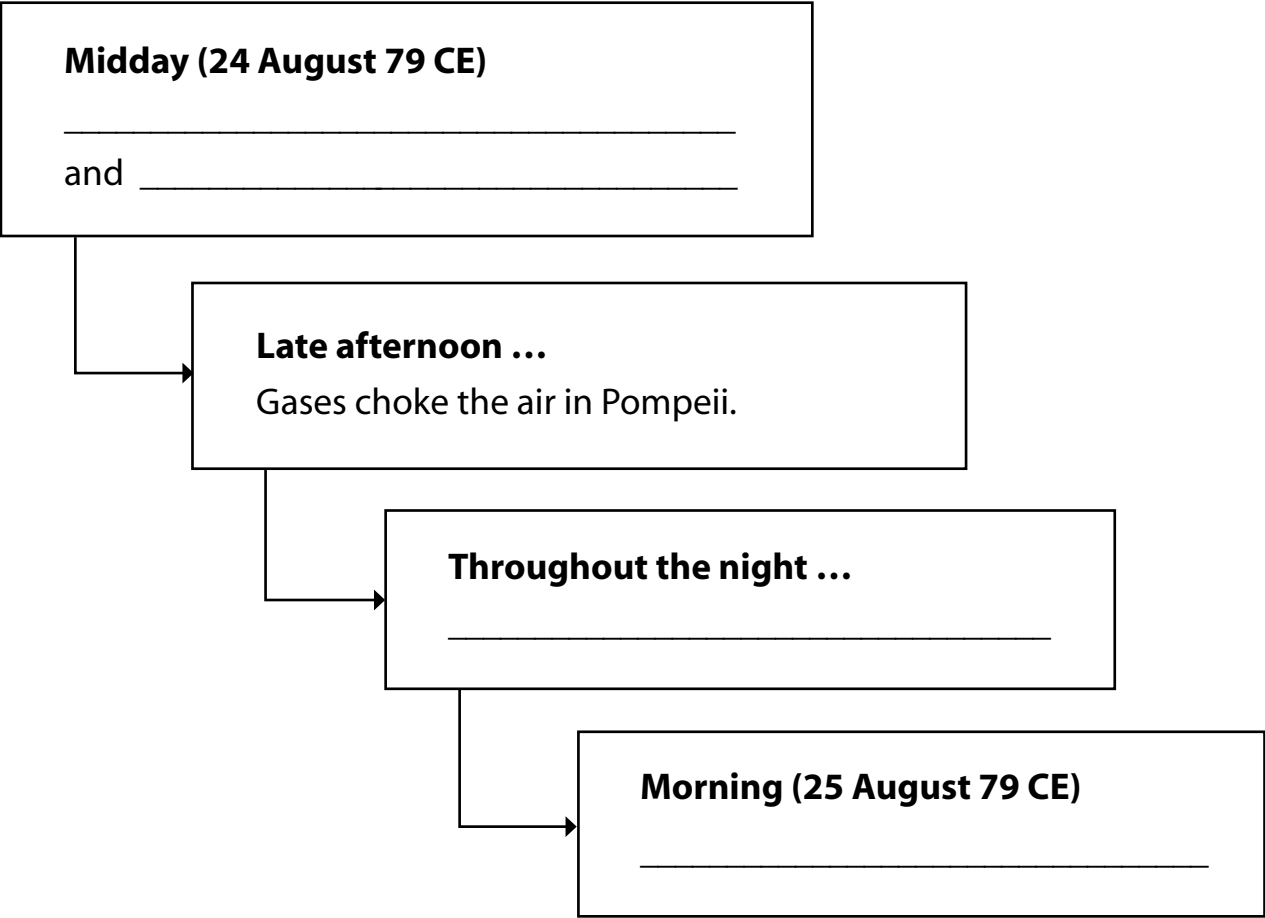


Roman graffiti can still be seen on the walls at Pompeii.

Mount Vesuvius erupts

 Organise the series of events that led to the end of Pompeii. Order the sentences in the box by writing the events in each section of the diagram below.

- 1 Pompeii is completely buried under four metres of dust and ash.
 - 2 Mount Vesuvius erupts.
 - 3 Pyroclastic materials continue to rain on Pompeii.
 - 4 Gases choke the air in Pompeii.
 - 5 Ash blackens the sky and drifts towards Pompeii.



A personal view of Pompeii

Pliny the Younger lived from 61 to 112 CE. As a teenager, Pliny lived by the Bay of Naples with his uncle. He witnessed the disaster hitting Pompeii from a distance. While his uncle sailed across the bay to help with the rescue efforts, Pliny remained behind. Sadly, Pliny's uncle did not survive. Afterwards, survivors told Pliny about what his uncle would have experienced there.

Pliny went on to become a Roman official. He wrote many letters. These were compiled into ten books. In one of these letters, he wrote about the disaster at Pompeii.



Elsewhere there was daylight, but my uncle and his friends were in darkness. It was much blacker than any normal night. After lighting torches and lamps, they ran down onto the beach to see if there was any chance of escape by boat, but the sea was too rough ... Broad sheets of fire and leaping flames glared through the darkness.

A volcanic eruption with huge columns of gases and ash is known as a **Plinian eruption**. It was named after Pliny because he was the first person to describe it.

- 1 Imagine that you are on board one of the ships that sail across the Bay of Naples to rescue the residents of Pompeii. Your ship remains at sea, unable to land. In your workbook, describe what you see, hear, smell and taste in the air. How do you feel when you realise you can't rescue anyone? What do you say to others upon your return?

Pompeii casts

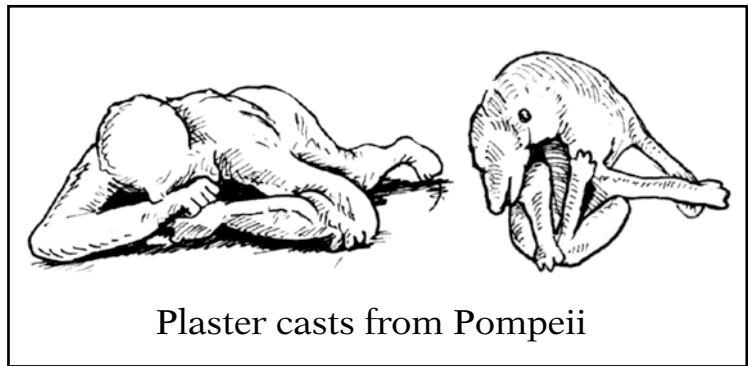
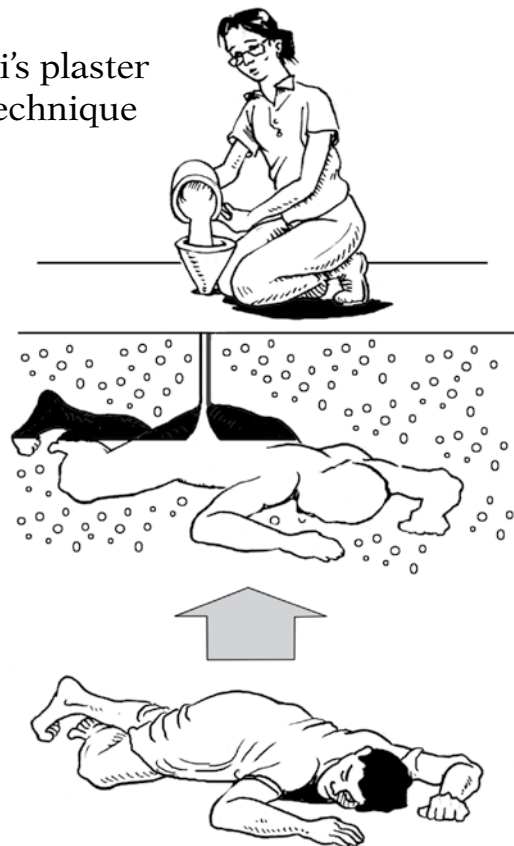
During the destruction at Pompeii, people were fully clothed as they tried to flee. Many choked from toxic gases and their bodies were soon covered by dust, ash and rocks. The **pyroclastic material** hardened into rock around the victims. Their bodies decomposed, leaving spaces in the rock.

In 1863 CE, Giuseppe Fiorelli was the director of **excavations** at Pompeii. He worked out a method for reconstructing the features of people, animals and objects that were buried. He made **casts** (plaster moulds) of the hollow spaces left in the hard rock.

Most of the people in Pompeii died very quickly. However, most of the casts for the Pompeii victims make it look like they died in agony. Experts know that this was really because their muscles contracted in the heat after they died.

Modern casts are still being made in Pompeii, but from harder substances. Experts have made a cast of a woman's body found in the ruins of Oplontis, near Torre Annunziata. This cast, made from glass fibre, shows her skeleton, along with some of the jewels she wore.

Fiorelli's plaster cast technique



-  **1** In what way has the invention of making casts added to our understanding of the people who lived in Pompeii?

Daily life in Pompeii

The table below lists plaster casts made at the site of Pompeii and some of the artefacts (items or objects) found nearby.

 1 Describe what the plaster casts might reveal about daily life in Pompeii.

Plaster cast and/or artefacts	Details of daily life in Pompeii
Plaster cast of a dog, with a chain and collar	Pompeians have family pets or guard dogs. This dog may have been chained up in the entrance hall of the house, left to guard the property until the wealthy owner returns.
Woman with her tunic pulled over her face. Children and a man are nearby.	
Cast of a bed near a wall in the servants' quarters of a home. A leather purse and a ring with a seal on it are nearby.	
A gladiator's helmet in an upstairs room of the gladiator training school.	

2 Imagine you are one of the people who stayed behind in Pompeii. In your workbook, write a short diary entry about your final moments.

Cause and effect

Use the Resource sheets ‘Pompeii is buried’ and ‘Pompeii casts’.

 1 Match the causes and effects in the table below. The first one has been done for you.

Cause	Effect (on town or people)
Early warnings from Mount Vesuvius	Pompeii is still being rebuilt in 79 CE.
Pompeii is buried, becomes a time capsule	Today, Pompeii is 2 kilometres inland.
Earthquake disaster, 17 years earlier	People make a choice to stay or go.
Pliny describes the ash cloud	The air in Pompeii becomes poisonous.
Volcanic ash fills the bay	To date, 60 per cent of Pompeii has been uncovered.
Deadly gases come from Vesuvius	Modern people can learn much about Ancient Roman times.
Excavations begin in 1748	‘Plinian explosion’ is named after a Roman official.
Fiorelli finds a method of making casts	The final moments of Pompeii’s fallen victims are recreated.

2 Think of a modern disaster where people have had to choose between staying or leaving. What would you do? Explain your answer.

Objectives

- To interpret diagrams and written information about Roman houses and use it to explain the daily life and habits of people in Ancient Rome
- To compare differing living conditions between rich and poor Romans in the city and country

Prior knowledge

Students should be aware that housing in any society varies between different classes and location, and is dependent on many factors, such as location, a person's employment and their socio-economic status.

Background

A lot of building material stretching across the empire has survived from Roman times, mainly their buildings constructed of stone and tile. Houses, especially ones belonging to the wealthy, were so well built that almost complete remains of villas and even whole towns have been found. However, there is little evidence of the wooden huts or wattle and daub buildings, thought to have been used throughout this time by many common citizens. The divide between the rich and poor is clearly signalled by their housing conditions, both in the city where many people lived and in the neighbouring countryside.

Starter activity

Ask students to think about how houses for people living in Ancient Rome may be different to their own house or flat. Consider also any differences between the rich and the poor.

Resource and Activity sheets

The Resource sheet 'Living in Rome' and Activity sheet 'Living in the country' describe four Roman dwellings, introducing students to the differences in living between the rich and the poor, urban and rural.

In the Activity sheets 'Roman houses (1)' and 'Roman houses (2)' students identify and label four housing styles, and then compare them.

Extension activity

- 1 Students could write a paragraph comparing a rich and poor townhouse in Ancient Rome.
- 2 Students could write real-estate advertisements for Ancient Roman properties for sale or lease. They could make models of a Roman villa for a class display.

Answers

Living in Rome 1 atrium, domus, insula, peristyle, lares
2 domus: spacious, cool, ground-level, airy, private insula: cramped, stuffy, multistorey, noisy, smelly,

Roman houses (1) 1 (clockwise) atrium, peristyle, mosaic tiles; city house 2 (clockwise) many rooms, slave quarters, storehouses; country house 3 (clockwise) windowless room, three storeys high, ground-level shop; city house 4 (clockwise) mud walls, thatched roof; country house.



Living in Rome



My family's walled **domus** has twelve rooms. Our study, office, bedrooms and kitchen are built around a cool **atrium** hall. The atrium has no roof, it is open to the sky, so we can catch rainwater in the pool below. Our garden is called a **peristyle**. It has a fountain and pool to cool the hot summer air. Our slaves have their own area. There are small shops at the front, which we rent to others. A front door opens onto the street.

I carry food and water buckets up the six flights of stairs to our **insula**. The rooms of the insula are small and many people live in the building. There are no windows and on these hot days I can hardly breathe. I must burn my oil lamp all day. There are always house fires in Rome. Day and night are so noisy, wagons roll by and workers call out from their ground floor shops ... The smells are disgusting! But I must not complain, or our **lares** will be angry.



- 1 Write the Latin word for each of the following:
- a central entrance hall with an open hole in the ceiling and a pool below _____
 - a single-storey town house with many rooms _____
 - small rented flat in a multistorey block with no water, kitchen or toilet _____
 - a walled garden courtyard _____
 - household gods _____

- 2 Choose the words in the box (right) that describe a domus and an insula. Complete the table in your workbook.

domus	insula
spacious	crowded

- spacious
cramped
cool
stuffy
airy
ground-level
noisy
multistorey
smelly
private

Living in the country



Julia Felix

Our **villa** has a **hypocaust** (underfloor heating) for winter warming, lead pipes that bring running water from the **aqueducts** (stone channels carrying water downhill to the towns). I love our paintings and the pictures on our mosaic floor tiles. Our slaves live here too. They tend the animals, as well as grow crops of figs, grapes and barley to feed the army. I wish we never had to go back to our **domus** (house) in Rome. I want to stay here in our country house forever.

Our **farmhouse** is only small, made of mud and sticks, but it is far away from the noise and sickness of town living. Father ploughs the field, turns the cow dung and keeps the corn free from weeds. The bees sometimes chase and sting me when I go to collect the honey. Soon we may have to move away, because an estate owner is looking to take over our land.



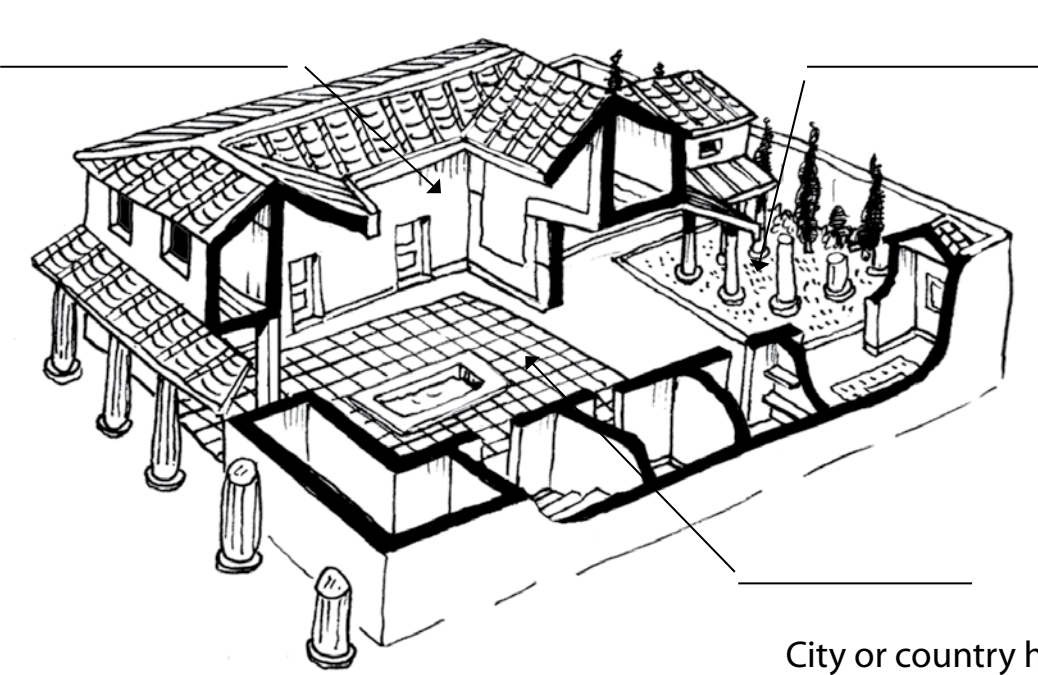
Quintus Lepidus

- 1 Imagine you are Julia Felix or Quintus Lepidus. Write an entry in your diary describing your feelings about country and city living, and about being rich or poor.

Roman houses (1)

Ancient Romans lived in four different kinds of houses. Two kinds were found in the city, and two in the country.

-  1 Using words from the word box, add labels to this illustration of a **domus**.
Write whether it is a city or country house.



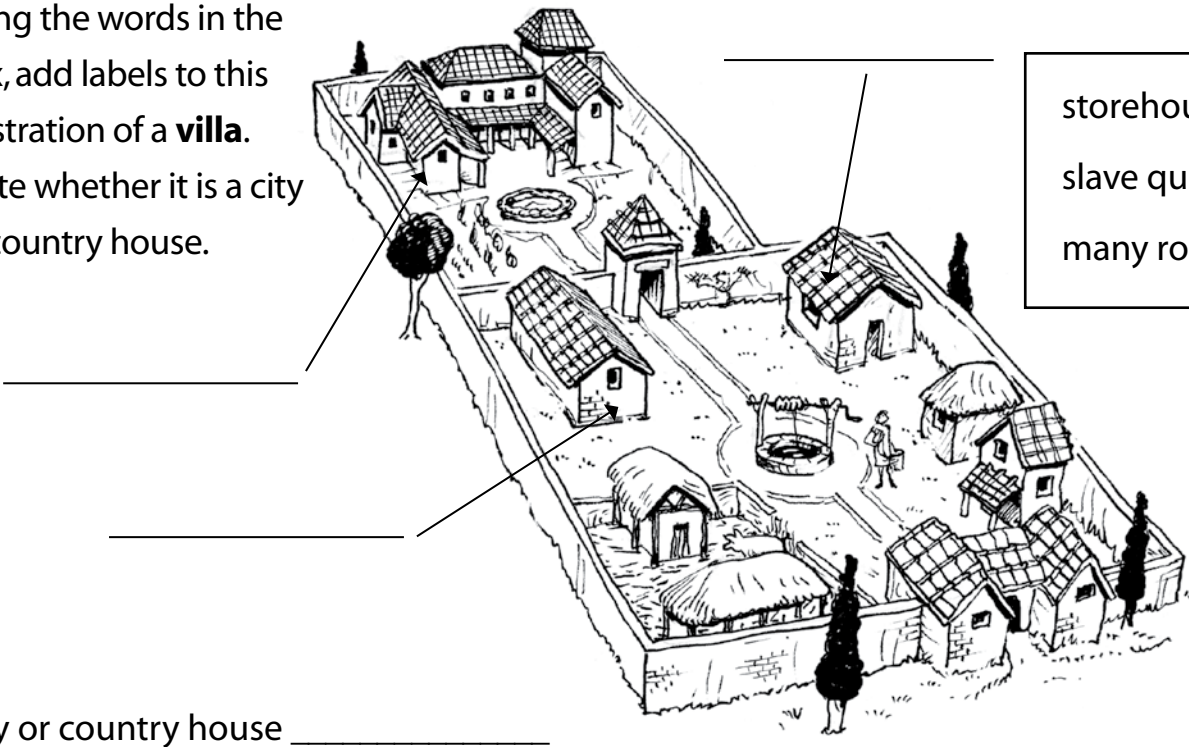
peristyle

mosaic tiles

atrium

City or country house _____

- 2 Using the words in the box, add labels to this illustration of a **villa**.
Write whether it is a city or country house.



storehouses

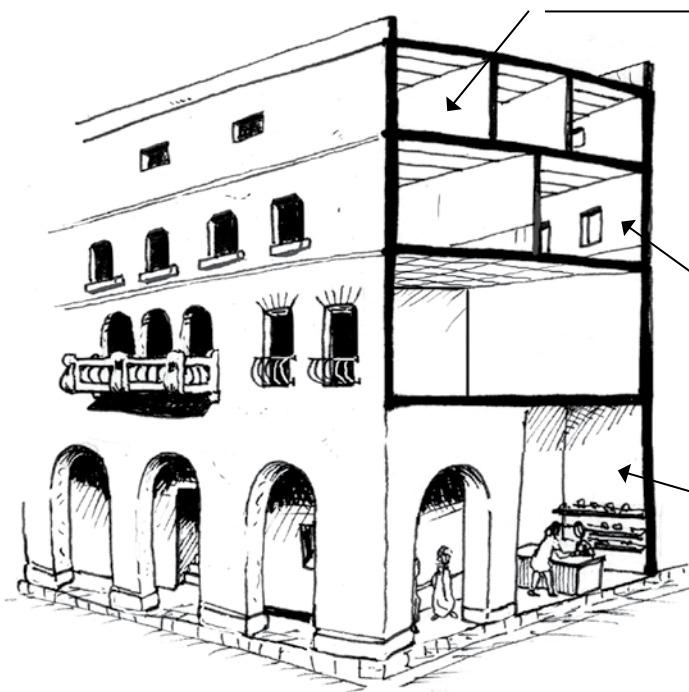
slave quarters

many rooms

City or country house _____

Roman houses (2)

3 Using the words in the box, add labels to this illustration of an **insula**.
Write whether it is a city or country house.

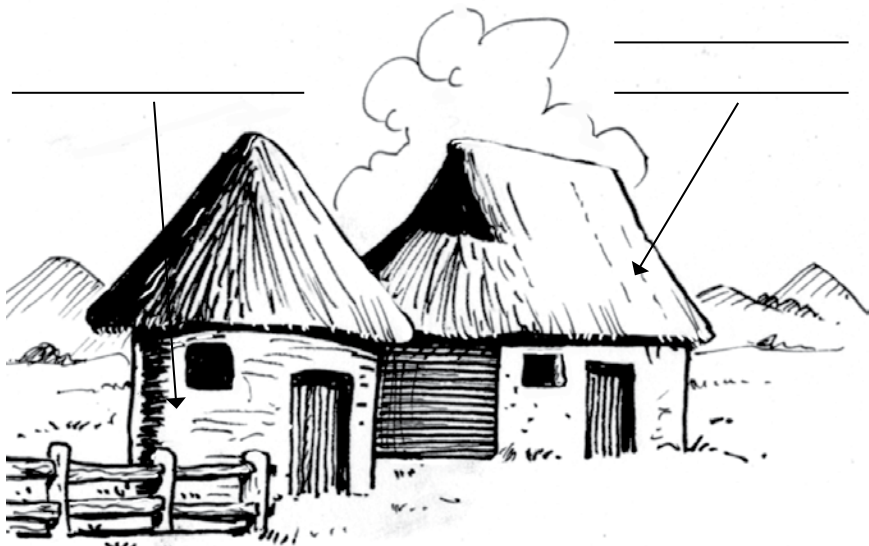


three storeys high
ground-level shop
windowless room

City or country house _____

4 Using the words in the box, add labels to this illustration of a **farmhouse**. Write whether it is a city or country house.

thatched roof
mud walls



City or country house _____

5 Which house would you prefer to live in? Why?

Objectives

- To identify the twelve major gods of the Roman Pantheon
- To describe how Roman contact with Greek culture led to the adoption of Greek gods and mythology, and to make a comparison.
- To identify and describe some of the religious festivals that marked the Roman calendar
- To use examples from the festival calendar to gain an understanding of the importance of religion in the everyday life of the Roman people.

Prior knowledge

Students should have some appreciation of the role religion plays in many people's life. They should know that not all religions are monotheistic, and that in the past people looked to religion rather than to science for explanations and understanding of the world around them.

Background

Etruscan admiration of Greek culture led to early Romans taking over the worship of Greek gods and goddesses for themselves. The Roman Pantheon had 12 major gods called the *Dii Consentes*. Romans changed the names of most gods (not Apollo) but kept the stories that went with them.

Religion was considered very important to the survival of the Roman nation, with public worship highly regulated through the many religious festivals that took place almost every week of the year. The *Pontifex Maximus*, elected by the people, oversaw the religious laws and drew up the festival calendar.

Starter activity

Ask students why they think many people believe in gods. Introduce the idea of mythology and religious stories that explain nature or aspects of the social world. Why do students think religion is still important to many people in our modern world?

Resource and Activity sheets

The Activity sheet 'Family tree of early Roman gods' introduces students to the Roman Pantheon.

The Activity sheet 'The Dii Consentes' helps them to identify 12 major Roman gods, their associated symbols and responsibilities, and their Greek counterparts.

The Activity sheet 'A god for every purpose' reinforces students' understanding of the worship of many gods in Roman daily life.

The Resource sheet 'Calendar of religious festivals' introduces students to some of the religious festivals of Rome, and the Activity sheet 'Religious festivals, beliefs and daily life' encourages them to think about how these related to the realities of Roman life.

Extension activities

Students could research other myths about Roman gods and explore what they tell us about Roman beliefs and understandings of their world. They could try writing their own myths to explain an aspect of the modern world.

Use the internet or textbooks to find pictures of Roman statues, temples, floor tiles or paintings showing the 12 Roman gods that made up the Dii Consentes. Make a collage of the pictures you find and label them with the gods' names.

Answers

The Dii Consentes Jupiter, Juno, god of war, goddess of love, Minerva, goddess of the moon, childbirth and the hunt, god of the sea, Mercury, Ceres, god of the home and hearth, Vulcan, god of the sun, music and healing.

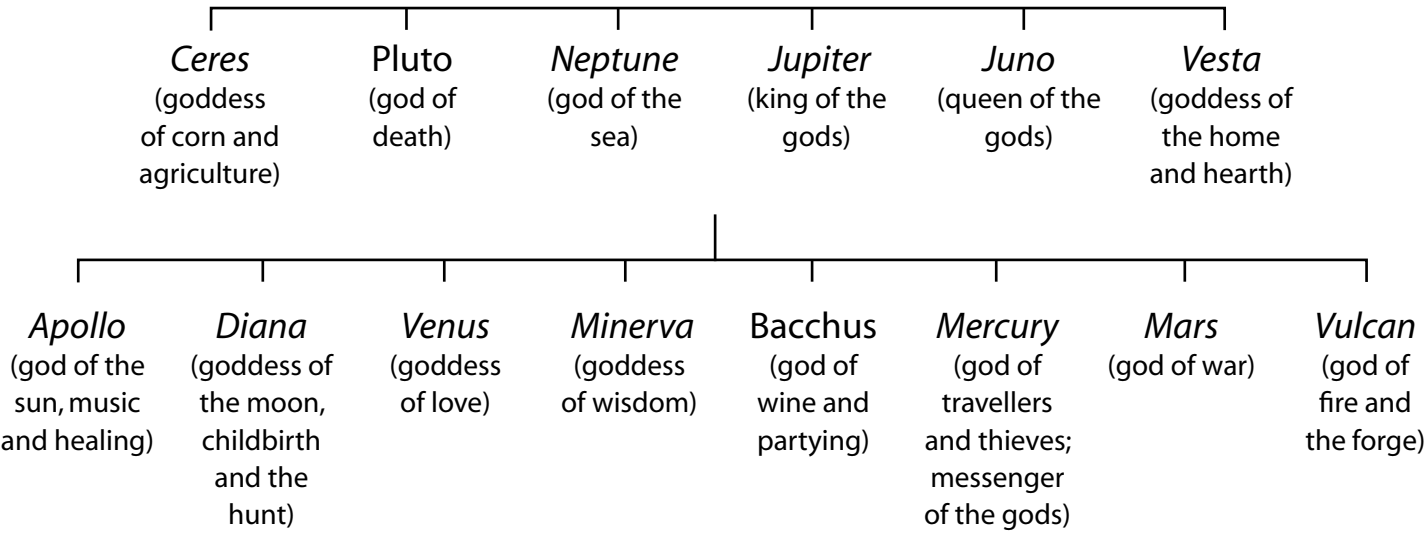
A god for every purpose Mercury, Minerva, Ceres, Vesta, Venus.

Religious festivals, beliefs and daily life Furrinalia, Fontinalia, ensure water supply; Lupercalia, celebrate fertility; Mindus, keep on the good side of the underworld spirits; Meditrinalia, to ensure good health; Saturnalia, recognition of reliance on slaves and honouring family life; Lares, honour the gods who guard households and give strength to the army.

Family tree of early Roman gods

Early Romans were **polytheistic**. This means they worshipped many gods. The gods played a very important role in the day-to-day life of all Romans.

The Romans had 12 major gods in their Roman **Pantheon** (all the gods of a people). They called these 12 gods the **Dii Consentes** (listed on the family tree below in italics). Their three most important gods, Jupiter, Juno and Minerva, formed a group called the **Capitoline Triad** (kap-i-tal-ayn try-add).



- 1 On the family tree, circle the gods and goddesses who made up the Capitoline Triad.
- 2 Highlight the 12 major gods that make up the Dii Consentes.
- 3 List the gods in the family tree that are not major gods.

The Dii Consentes

The Romans admired the gods of Ancient Greece so much they adopted them for their **pantheon** (all the gods of a people). They changed most of the gods’ names, but kept many of the same symbols, responsibilities and stories about them.

-  1 Use the Activity sheet ‘Family tree of early Roman gods’ to fill in the gaps in this table about the 12 major gods.

Roman god	Greek god	Symbol	Responsibility
	Zeus	eagle, thunderbolt	king of the gods
	Hera	peacock, pomegranate	queen of the gods
Mars	Ares	spear, shield	
Venus	Aphrodite	seashell mirror	
	Athena	owl	goddess of wisdom, and a member of the Capitoline Triad
Diana	Artemis	bow & arrows	
Neptune	Poseidon	trident	
	Hermes	winged hat, sandals	messenger of the gods, and god of travellers and thieves
	Demeter	bundle of grain	goddess of the earth and agriculture
Vesta	Hestia	sacred flame, donkey	
	Hephaestus	fire, axe, hammer	god of fire and the forge
Apollo	Apollo	laurel tree, lyre (harp)	

A god for every purpose

1 Suggest which gods these Romans would pray to for help.



I am soon to go into battle against the Gauls.

Answer: Mars (the god of war)



I wish to send this message safely to my family in Herculaneum.

Answer: _____



I must learn all my Latin grammar before the **grammaticus** (teacher) tests me.

Answer: _____



I hope we have a good crop of corn this season.

Answer: _____



I need to keep the hearth fire burning brightly, so that our family is warm through this icy winter.

Answer: _____



I hope to find a woman who loves me for my mind and not my muscles!

Answer: _____

Calendar of religious festivals

The **Pontifex Maximus** (pon-tuh-feks max-i-mus) was the religious leader voted in by the people. He drew up a calendar of religious festivals so people could honour the gods and goddesses.

January <i>Festival of Agonalia</i> January 1 and 5 Figs, dates and honey are offered to Janos, god of doors. Family members receive gifts of fruit and money. Romans prayed to Janos for advice as he was the god of doors, beginnings and endings.	February <i>Lupercalia</i> Celebrates love and fertility. Honours Faunus, god of nature and fertility, and Lupercus, god of shepherds.	March <i>Lares</i> Teams of 12 men run through the streets in body armour to honour the Lares, gods who guard households. Soldiers will soon begin fighting again. They do not fight in winter.
April On April 1, Ancient Romans believe the Mindus, the passage to the underworld, opens to allow the spirits of the dead to roam freely.	May <i>Ambarvalia</i> The gods Ceres and Dea Dia bless the growing of plants. Also on May 15, people make animal sacrifices to honour the River Tiber.	June <i>Lesser Quinquatrus</i> Flute players who play at religious ceremonies celebrate this three-day festival in honour of Minerva.
July <i>Furrinalia</i> Honours the goddess Furrina. Celebrates those who search for underground water sources.	August <i>Consualia</i> Held for the god of grain, Consus. Flowers are draped around the necks of working horses and oxen. They are rested from work.	September <i>Meditrinalia</i> Offerings of fruit are given to Meditrina, the goddess of medicine.
October <i>Fontinalia</i> Flowers are thrown into the springs and wells to honour Fons, god of the water source.	November <i>Ludi Plebeii</i> These plebeian games honour Jupiter. After a procession from the Forum to the Circus Maximus, the common people enjoy theatre and athletic events.	December <i>Saturnalia</i> Kind owners serve their slaves a special meal and give them a day off (on December 25) during this mid-winter festival in honour of Saturn.

Religious festivals, beliefs and daily life

 1 Use the Resource sheet ‘Calendar of religious festivals’ to complete the table.

Aspect of Roman life	Festival(s)	Why was it important to honour the god(s) with this festival
crops	Ambervalia Consualia	need a plentiful supply of food
water		
fertility (having children)		
death/afterlife		
medicine		
slaves		
army		

Objectives

- To gain an understanding that Romans were great road builders
- To identify and describe how and why Romans linked the known ancient world through their road network
- To draw conclusions about the significance and legacy of the Roman road system

Prior knowledge

Students should bring to this unit a basic awareness of the importance of a road system as a transport and communication network.

Background

Ancient Romans were able to build an extraordinary network of roads in the known ancient world. Their straight and direct routes brought trade, improved social conditions and prosperity to many people in and outside of Rome. Such a great achievement came about through a combination of immense creativity and innovation (through designs and invention), as well as a well-organised, highly trained industry of 'forced' labour (army and slavery). The legacy left for future generations is still apparent, with some roads and many routes still in use today.

Starter activity

Ask the following questions to get students thinking about how roads affect the way we organise our society. Why are roads important? Why do we build freeways? What do road builders have to consider when making a road (direct route, road safety, effect on natural landscapes)? What equipment and machinery do we use?

Resource and activity sheets

The Activity sheet 'The Appian Way opens' introduces students to Rome's first major road achievement. They learn about Roman technology in the Activity sheet 'Master road builders'.

In the Activity sheet 'All roads lead to Rome' students use a map to locate the expansion of the road system during the empire, before reflecting on Rome's motives for developing such a network.

The Activity sheet 'Remarkable Roman road facts' provides students with further information for them to interpret.

The cloze activity on the Activity sheet 'Great builders' is a summary of the unit.

Extension activity

You can still travel along the Via Appia today. Students could use the internet to find some recent photos of it and write captions about the road's use through the ages. They could imagine how it might look 2320 years from now.

Answers

Master road builders 1 camber – a gentle curve over the width of the road allows water to drain away; road hardener – a mixture of volcanic ash, lime, gravel and water that sets hard; groma – surveyor's tool, sights out a straight line or sets lines at right angles. 2 chorobate – spirit level; camber – camber; road hardener – concrete.

All roads lead to Rome 2 England, Scotland, Egypt, Spain, Iraq 3 Fast movement of army; Communication network; Power from the top; A more prosperous empire; Imports to Rome; Wealth for Rome.

Remarkable Roman road facts 1 Thumbs up; 2 Thumbs down; 3 Thumbs up; 4 Thumbs down; 5 Thumbs up; 6 Thumbs down

Great builders 1 builders, invented, tools, well-paved, empire, surveyors, peace, travel; business, routes, inventions; Extra word: ancient 2 False; 3 False; 4 True

The Appian Way opens

Via Appia opens

The Senate today put on games at the local amphitheatre to celebrate the opening of its first major link road, the **Via Appia**. Linking Rome to Brundisium on the south-east coast, this direct road is great news for the Republic. Not only will our troops better defend our coast, but also the road opens up a faster route for our many Greek friends who already visit this glorious city.

Leading engineer Dio Commodus Cassius says the surface will last for a long time. ‘We have used four layers, about a metre deep from top to bottom. A chalk and sand base

is tightly packed with big stones. A layer of paving stones tops sand, gravel and broken bricks.’

Cassius adds, ‘To make the foundation even firmer we used a new **hardener**. Volcanic ash, lime, bits of gravel and broken rock mix with water and set hard. The road is also higher in the middle due to a **camber**, which curves down into drains on either side.’

He promises that not even Apollo’s four-horse chariot will get stuck in the mud on this road. Hail to our sun God as he crosses the sky to give light to Rome!

Cassius gives glowing praise to his team. ‘We owe them a lot. Equipment such as the **groma**

helps us to measure out land and lay out a straight road, while the **chorobate** is a great way to level the surface. Soldiers and slaves have also done a top building job.’

He rejects concerns about traveller safety. ‘Bah! No harm will come to anyone! We already have slaves building **mansiones** along the road where users can have a brief rest or meal, even stay overnight if they wish. A great boom for the traders too!’

He says there is much excitement in the Republic about future road plans. ‘One day, we plan to be the master road builder of the known world.’

312 BCE

-  1 Imagine you are a senator visiting the Via Appia. Write a report in your workbook about benefits the road is bringing to Rome. Use these sentence starters below as a guide.

A new direct route means ...

Tourism will increase because ...

The army can ...

New trading places (shops, inns) along the road will help ...

One improvement I suggest is ...

Master road builders

-  1 Read the Resource sheet ‘The Appian Way opens’, then complete the table below. Match the name of the technology (equipment, designs or materials) used by Romans in their road building with the correct description.
- 2 In the last column, select words from the box below to describe similar technologies that are used today.

concrete spirit level camber

Ancient technology	Description	Similar modern technology
chorobate	a mixture of volcanic ash, lime, gravel and water that sets hard	
camber	surveyor’s tool, checks if surface is level	
road hardener	surveyor’s tool, sights out a straight line or sets lines at right angles	
groma	a gentle curve over the width of the road allows water to drain away	

- 3 Which ancient technology is like the technology we use today?
-
- 4 ‘The groma – the tool that built the empire.’ What do you think this saying means?
-
-

All roads lead to Rome

Romans became the master road builders. The map below shows the 80 450 kilometres of roads that covered Rome’s empire at its height in 114 CE.

 1 Use the key to fill in the boxes on the map with the correct letter.

Key

- A Roads link to Rome.
- B Roads reach Gaul.
- C Roads reach the far corners of the northern empire to Britannia and Caledonia.
- D Roads reach the southern empire to Aegyptus.
- E Roads reach the eastern empire to Mesopotamia.
- F Roads reach the western empire to Hispania.



2 Using an atlas if you need to, find the modern names for the countries mentioned in the map key.

Britannia = _____ Caledonia = _____ Aegyptus = _____
Hispania = _____ Mesopotamia = _____ Gaul = _____

3 Fill in the table below to explain why the Romans built so many roads. Choose your headings from the boxed list.

Reason	How roads helped achieve this	
	Soldiers can march the shortest distance to all corners of the empire.	Power from the top
	Official messages and reports are sent quickly to and from Rome.	Imports to Rome
	The emperor can keep strict control of the empire.	Communication network
	Rome can bring in grain and other goods for its citizens from many other places.	Wealth for Rome
	Taxes of silver, gold, goods and animals are regularly transported to Rome.	Fast movement of army

Remarkable Roman road facts

Read what these people have to say about Roman roads then circle thumbs up or thumbs down to show whether the statements below are correct or not.



We're building all the roads, but I bet a legend grows after the fall of the empire that giants and gnomes built them.



That's right men, place those milestones (numbered stone markers) by the side of each road to mark the distance between settlements.



No problem is too great for our army! They build large strong bridges over rivers. They add logs to the road base to make extra solid foundations for roads over wetlands. They peg out every road to ensure it is the shortest and most direct way to the next town. If a hill gets in the way, they simply tunnel through.



We Romans have set up a **cursus publicus** (postal system). Riders on horseback carry and deliver the mail. By changing horses regularly, riders can make 70 kilometres a day. They can cross the empire in 100 days. As well, they protect people on government business from attacks by robbers.

1 'A tunnel through this hill will make our road three kilometres shorter.'



2 'This ground's way too marshy, we'll never build a road across.'



3 'I can cross the empire on horseback in 100 days.'



4 'Of course, it's true! Giants built all Roman roads.'



5 'This letter must be delivered by sunset. It's early morning and I'm only 70 kilometres away. I'll easily make it.'



6 'I don't call losing my way or an attack by a robber much of a fun trip. I'm not using the road if there are no milestones or security.'



Great builders

 1 Select words from the box to complete these sentences. There is one extra word. Circle it after you complete the summary.

business	surveyors	empire	travel	inventions	ancient
well-paved	tools	routes	peace	invented	builders

The Romans were great _____. They _____ many building techniques and _____. They built _____ roads, which went to all parts of their _____. They used the skills of, _____, engineers, architects and builders.

The Roman road network brought prosperity and _____ across the empire. They helped people _____ across the empire. Their roads also provided new _____ opportunities for people.

Many of their roads and _____ are still in use today. Many of their _____ and methods are still used.

Circle whether each of the following questions is true or false.

- 2 Markers used to show travellers how far they had to go were called ‘measures’.
True / False
- 3 The Romans only built roads where there was flat land that was easy to build on.
True / False
- 4 Roads were patrolled by riders and safe to travel on.
True / False

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